WEEK
10

COMPREHENSIVE FINAL STUDY GUIDE

Weeks 1-9, Cumulative -- with MOA + Lecture Figures

Built around Dr. Zhang's live Final Exam Review · 30 questions · reuses quiz material

This Guide Covers:

- All 12 primary meridians -- full ID cards + real MOA (Deadman) channel figures, one per page
- The 3 Circuits (Outer/Inner/Middle), 24-hr clock, direction rules -- Dr. Zhang's #1 review emphasis
- GV, CV, and all 8 Extraordinary Vessels -- with lecture-sourced vessel figures + Confluent Point pairs
- The 15 Collaterals (Luo-Connecting points) + a low-priority summary of Divergent/Sinew/Cutaneous material
- Full Five Shu (Transport) Points master table -- all 60 points, all 12 meridians
- A dedicated Exam Traps page consolidating every verified fact from every weekly Cram Sheet

FINAL EXAM: Week 10 · 30 questions · cumulative, reuses Quiz 1-6 material

Per Dr. Zhang, live in Week 9: divergent channels / collaterals detail NOT covered in her review.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

What Dr. Zhang Said Is On The Final 3

Master Pathway Table & Direction Rules 3

Pathway Distribution (Lecture Figures) 5

Six Divisions & Circuit Diagrams 6

- LU -- Lung 9
- LI -- Large Intestine 12
- ST -- Stomach 15
- SP -- Spleen 20
- HT -- Heart 23
- SI -- Small Intestine 26
- BL -- Bladder 29
- KI -- Kidney 32
- PC -- Pericardium 35
- SJ -- San Jiao / Triple Energizer 38
- GB -- Gallbladder 41
- LR -- Liver 44

Eight Extraordinary Vessels 47

Eight Confluent Points 49

Meridians vs. Collaterals + 15 Collaterals 51

Five Shu (Transport) Points -- Master Table 52

Exam Traps -- Consolidated 53

Course Map -- Weeks 1-10 54

WHAT DR. ZHANG SAID IS ON THE FINAL

Sourced directly from the Week 9 live transcript

30 questions total	Confirmed verbally in the Week 9 live class when a student asked directly: "how many questions we have in final exam" -> "30 questions."
Cumulative, reuses quiz material	Per Week 6: "the final exam mentions all the questions, including in the final examination, [are] concerns from each quiz, not new question." The final draws from Quiz 1-6 content directly -- review EVERY quiz you've taken, not just lecture notes.
No new content Week 9->10	Week 9 had no new quiz or homework -- it was 100% review. Week 10 is the final exam itself. Homework 5 must be submitted before the final or the grade cannot be entered.
Review = pathways, not divergent/collateral detail	Direct quote, Week 9: a student asked whether the final "will include the last week and this week's lecture regarding collaterals and divergent points" -- Dr. Zhang answered "No, no. In the review part, all the content included in the review part, we will not tell you about the divergent and collaterals." Muscle Regions and Cutaneous Regions were also not part of her review slides. Know the concepts, but they are LOW-YIELD for the final vs. primary pathways.
Her review slides emphasized	(1) All 12 primary meridian pathways -- start point, end point, direction, pertaining organ, connecting organ, and the region(s) each crosses (ear, nose, eye, genitals, tongue). (2) The three Circuits (Anterior/Outer, Posterior/Inner, Middle) and their sequence. (3) Five Shu (Transport) Points -- full master table, all 12 meridians. (4) Eight Confluent Points and their Extraordinary Vessel pairings. (5) The Eight Extraordinary Vessels themselves (started via their confluent points, e.g. "Yin Chao and Yang Chao [start] at BL62 and KI6").
Clinical evidence content is NOT exam material	The PCOS/PMOS acupuncture protocol, the JAMA urinary incontinence RCT, and the EMMA robotic-massage pilot data were presented as clinical context/enrichment, separate from "the review for the final examination" segment -- do not spend final-prep time memorizing these numbers.
"If you understand the slides, you can pass the final exam very easily."	Dr. Zhang's own closing framing of the Week 9 review lecture -- her review deck (not the raw transcript detail) is the single best final-prep source, supplemented by re-drilling each week's Quiz Kit.

MASTER PATHWAY TABLE -- ALL 12 PRIMARY MERIDIANS

Dr. Zhang's #1 review emphasis

Narrow record format -- built to read cleanly on any screen, no horizontal scrolling needed.

LU -- Lung
Class: Hand Taiyin · Y/Y: Yin · Direction: Chest -> Hand · Circuit: Outer / Anterior · Clock: 3-5 AM

LI -- Large Intestine
Class: Hand Yangming · Y/Y: Yang · Direction: Hand -> Head · Circuit: Outer / Anterior · Clock: 5-7 AM

ST -- Stomach
Class: Foot Yangming · Y/Y: Yang · Direction: Head -> Foot · Circuit: Outer / Anterior · Clock: 7-9 AM

SP -- Spleen
Class: Foot Taiyin · Y/Y: Yin · Direction: Foot -> Chest · Circuit: Outer / Anterior · Clock: 9-11 AM

HT -- Heart
Class: Hand Shaoyin · Y/Y: Yin · Direction: Chest -> Hand · Circuit: Inner / Posterior · Clock: 11 AM-1 PM

SI -- Small Intestine
Class: Hand Taiyang · Y/Y: Yang · Direction: Hand -> Head · Circuit: Inner / Posterior · Clock: 1-3 PM

BL -- Bladder
Class: Foot Taiyang · Y/Y: Yang · Direction: Head -> Foot · Circuit: Inner / Posterior · Clock: 3-5 PM

KI -- Kidney
Class: Foot Shaoyin · Y/Y: Yin · Direction: Foot -> Chest · Circuit: Inner / Posterior · Clock: 5-7 PM

PC -- Pericardium
Class: Hand Jueyin · Y/Y: Yin · Direction: Chest -> Hand · Circuit: Middle · Clock: 7-9 PM

SJ -- San Jiao (Triple Burner)
Class: Hand Shaoyang · Y/Y: Yang · Direction: Hand -> Head · Circuit: Middle · Clock: 9-11 PM

GB -- Gallbladder
Class: Foot Shaoyang · Y/Y: Yang · Direction: Head -> Foot · Circuit: Middle · Clock: 11 PM-1 AM

LR -- Liver
Class: Foot Jueyin · Y/Y: Yin · Direction: Foot -> Chest · Circuit: Middle · Clock: 1-3 AM

DIRECTION-OF-FLOW RULES

Rule	Direction
Yin meridians of the HAND	Chest -> Hand
Yang meridians of the HAND	Hand -> Head
Yang meridians of the FOOT	Head -> Foot
Yin meridians of the FOOT	Foot -> Chest/Abdomen

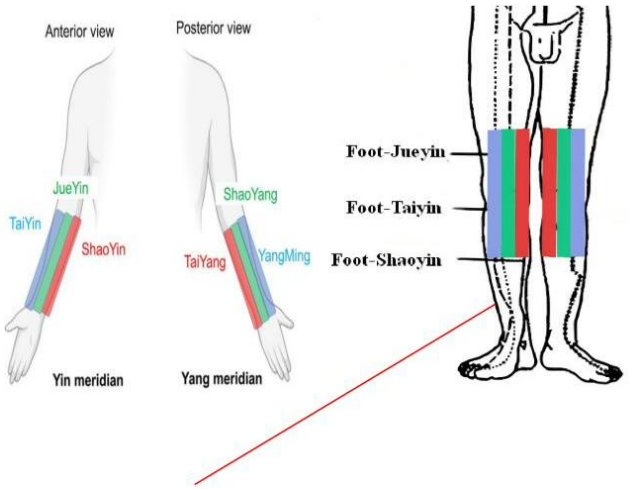
HAND-OFF POINTS BETWEEN CIRCUITS

Transition	Location	Example
Hand Yin -> Hand Yang	at the FINGERS	LU7 branch meets LI1 (index finger)
Hand Yang -> Foot Yang	at the FACE	LI20 meets ST1/BL1 area
Foot Yang -> Foot Yin	at the TOES	ST42/SP1 (great toe)
Foot Yin -> Hand Yin	internally, at the CHEST	SP -> HT (diaphragm); same pattern for KI->PC, LR->LU

PATHWAY DISTRIBUTION ON THE BODY -- LECTURE FIGURES

WHERE each division sits -- not just the flow order above

Distribution on the Limbs



Twelve regular meridians:

Limbs: Medial aspect--*Yin* meridians
Lateral aspect--*Yang* meridians

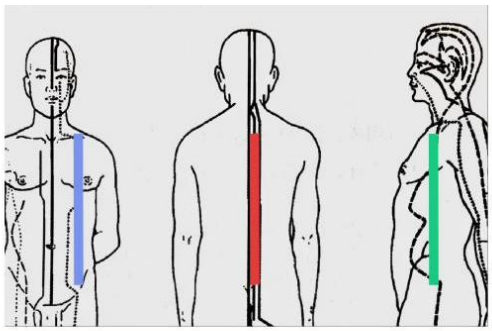
- Anterior--*Taiyin--Yangming*
- Posterior--*Shaoyin—Taiyang*
- Middle--*Jueyin--Shaoyang*

Limbs（四肢）	Medial aspect（内侧）— Yin meridians（阴经）	Lateral aspect（外侧）— Yang meridians（阳经）
Anterior（前）	Taiyin（太阴）	Yangming（阳明）
Middle（中）	Jueyin（厥阴）	Shaoyang（少阳）
Posterior（后）	Shaoyin（少阴）	Taiyang（太阳）

The Liver Meridian of Foot-Jueyin ascends to an area 8 cun above the medial malleolus, where it runs across and behind the Spleen Meridian of Foot-Taiyin

Medial aspect of the limbs = Yin meridians. Lateral aspect = Yang meridians. On the arm/leg cross-section: Anterior strip = Taiyin/Yangming, Middle strip = Jueyin/Shaoyang, Posterior strip = Shaoyin/Taiyang.

Distribution on the Head & Trunk



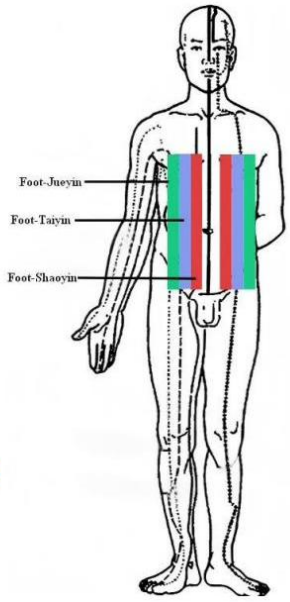
区域 Region	位置 Position	经络拼音 Meridian	中文名称 Chinese Name
Head and Trunk（头与躯干，阳经分布）	Anterior（前部）	Yangming	阳明
	Posterior（后部）	Taiyang	太阳
	Lateral（侧部）	Shaoyang	少阳
---	---	---	---
Trunk (Chest and Abdomen，躯干胸腹，阴经分布) *排序规则：从前正中线向外侧排列*	Anterior（胸腹前部）	Shaoyin	少阴
		Taiyin	太阴
		Jueyin	厥阴

Head and Trunk:

- Anterior--*Yangming*
- Posterior—Taiyang
- Lateral---Shaoyang

Trunk (Chest and Abdomen):

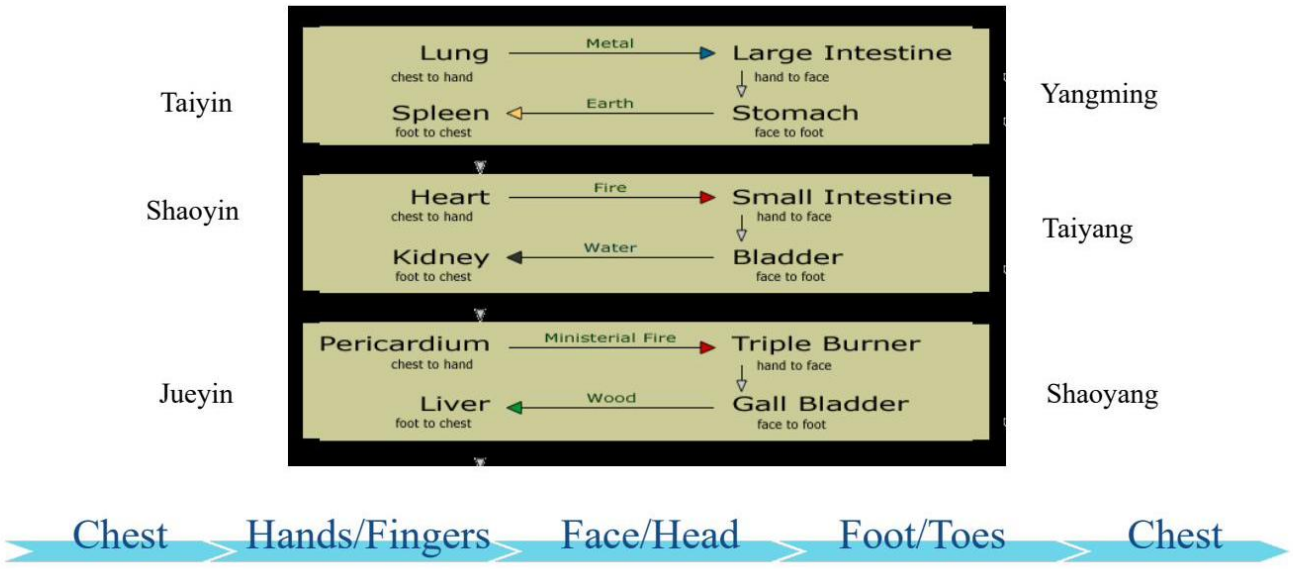
- Anterior--Shaoyin, Taiyin, Juey



On the head and trunk the same 3-way split applies: Anterior = Yangming, Posterior = Taiyang, Lateral = Shaoyang. On the chest/abdomen specifically, the order from the midline outward is Shaoyin, Taiyin, Jueyin.

SIX DIVISIONS -- TAIYIN/YANGMING/SHAOYIN/TAIYANG/JUEYIN/SHAOYANG

How the six divisions map onto the 3 circuits



Source: Dr. Zhang's Week 1 lecture deck -- "Three Main Circuits in the Flow of Qi"

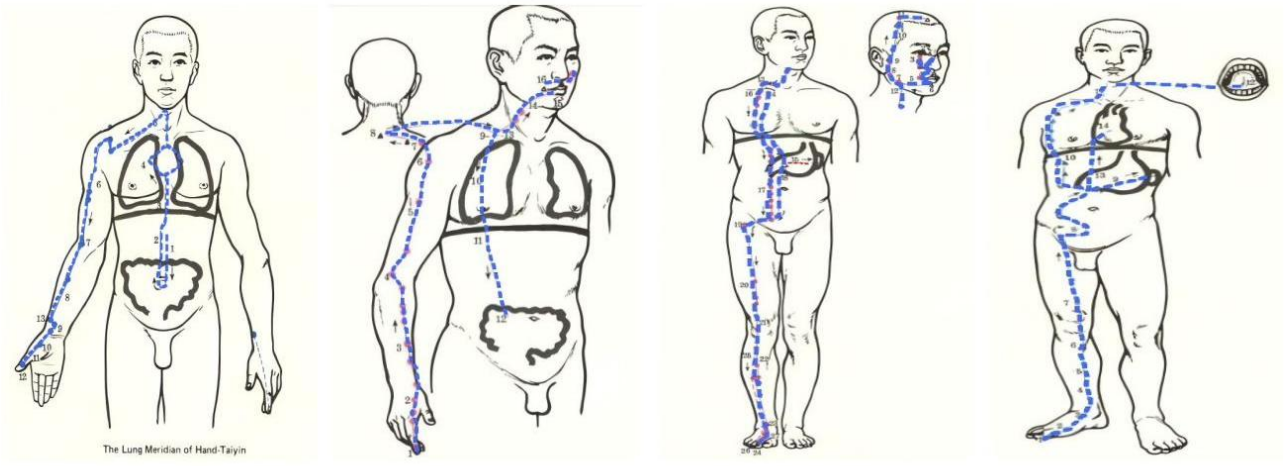
Each ROW is one circuit (Outer/Anterior, Inner/Posterior, Middle), and each row pairs a Yin division on the left (Taiyin, Shaoyin, Jueyin) with its Yang partner on the right (Yangming, Taiyang, Shaoyang) -- exactly the same Yin/Yang channel pairs from the Master Pathway Table, just visualized with the element colors and hand-off arrows (chest -> hand -> face -> foot -> chest) laid out together.

HOW TO READ THIS DIAGRAM

Rows = Circuits	Top row is the Outer/Anterior Circuit, middle row the Inner/Posterior Circuit, bottom row the Middle Circuit -- the exact same 3 circuits from the Master Pathway Table, in the same order.
Left column = Yin	Taiyin (LU/SP), Shaoyin (HT/KI), Jueyin (PC/LR) -- each is the FIRST channel Qi reaches when a circuit begins at the chest.
Right column = Yang	Yangming (LI/ST), Taiyang (SI/BL), Shaoyang (SJ/GB) -- each receives Qi from its Yin partner at the hand, then carries it up to the face before handing off to the foot.
Colored arrows = the Five-Phase link	Metal (LU-LI), Earth (SP-ST), Fire (HT-SI), Water (KI-BL), Ministerial Fire (PC-SJ), Wood (LR-GB) -- the internal-external pair for each row shares one Element.
Bottom arrow band	Chest -> Hands/Fingers -> Face/Head -> Foot/Toes -> Chest -- the SAME 4-stage hand-off sequence that repeats identically across all 3 circuits, just with different channels.

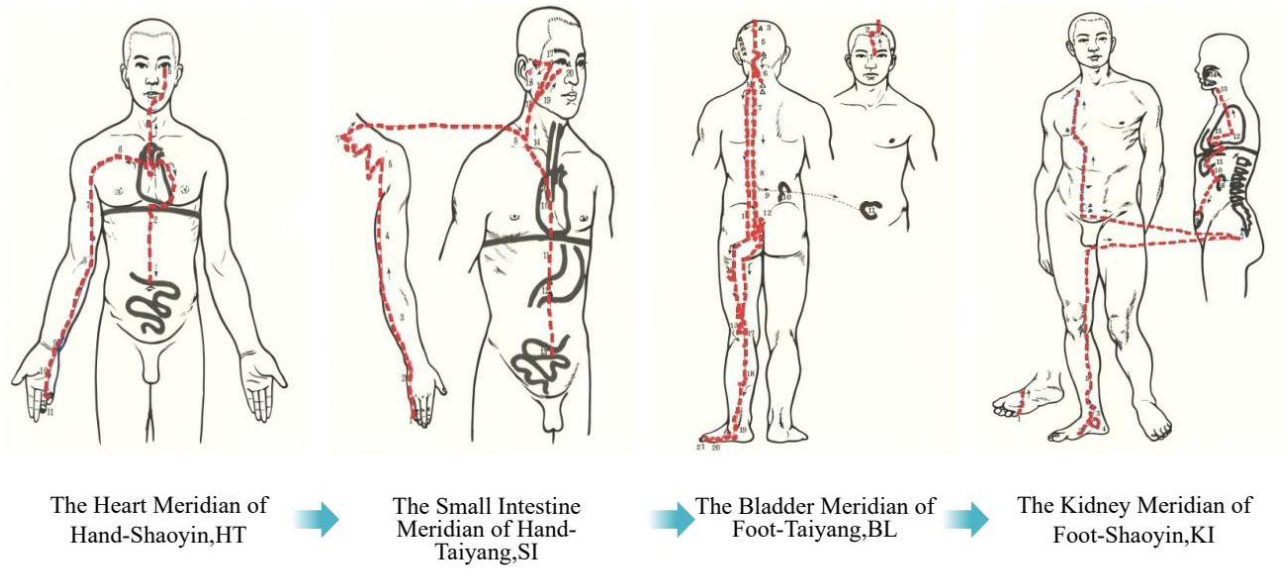
CIRCUIT DIAGRAMS -- EACH CIRCUIT'S 4 CHANNELS, IN SEQUENCE

Anterior Circuit -- LU -> LI -> ST -> SP



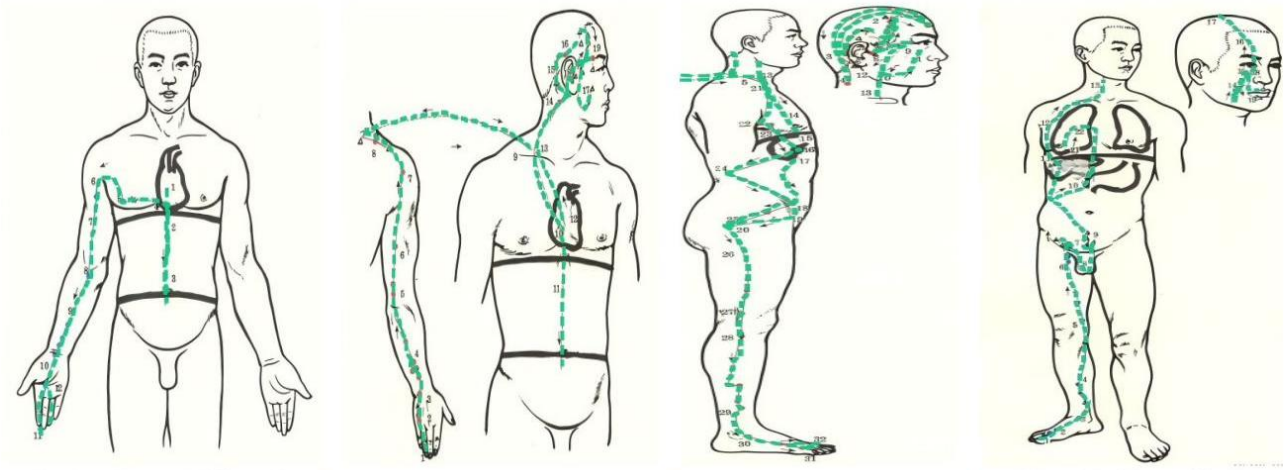
First circuit to complete (Weeks 2-3). Metal (LU-LI) and Earth (SP-ST) elements. Notice ST's detour through the face before descending -- this is why most of ST's 11 crossing points sit on the face and head.

Posterior Circuit -- HT -> SI -> BL -> KI



Second circuit to complete (Weeks 4-5). Fire (HT-SI) and Water (KI-BL) elements. BL's long dual-line back course and KI's heel-curving finish are the two longest, most exam-tested pathways in this circuit.

Middle Circuit -- PC -> SJ -> GB -> LR



Third circuit to complete (Week 6). Ministerial Fire (PC-SJ) and Wood (LR-GB) elements. GB's zigzag "Z-shape" head course is unique among all 12 channels -- a common exam identification question.

LU -- LUNG

11 pts | Metal | Yin | 3-5 AM | Chest -> Hand

Category	Detail
Full name	Lung Meridian of Hand-Taiyin
Pertains / Connects	Lung / Large Intestine
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL13 Feishu / LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual)
Yuan-Source	LU9 Taiyuan
Luo-Connecting	LU7 Lieque
He-Sea	LU5 Chize
Xi-Cleft	LU6 Kongzui
Confluent	LU7 -- opens Ren Mai (paired w/ KI6)
Command Point	LU7 -- head/neck
Crossing Points	none named (terminal Yin channel)
First / Last Point	LU1 Zhongfu / LU11 Shaoshang

FUNCTIONS

- Governs Qi and respiration ("the Lung governs Qi")
- Controls the skin and body hair (the exterior defense layer)
- Internally, LU connects to the Middle Jiao/Stomach -- this is why cough is sometimes treated by needling ST or SP points
- Diffuses and descends Lung Qi; regulates the water passages
- LU1 is the Lung's OWN Front-Mu -- unusual, since most Front-Mu points sit on the Ren Mai or another channel

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Cough, wheezing, shortness of breath, chest fullness and distension, asthma
- Edema (Lung governs the upper water passages)
- Sore throat, nasal congestion, voice/throat disorders
- Pain along the channel: chest, shoulder, medial arm to thumb
- Susceptibility to external pathogenic invasion (Wind-Cold/Wind-Heat) via the skin/exterior

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

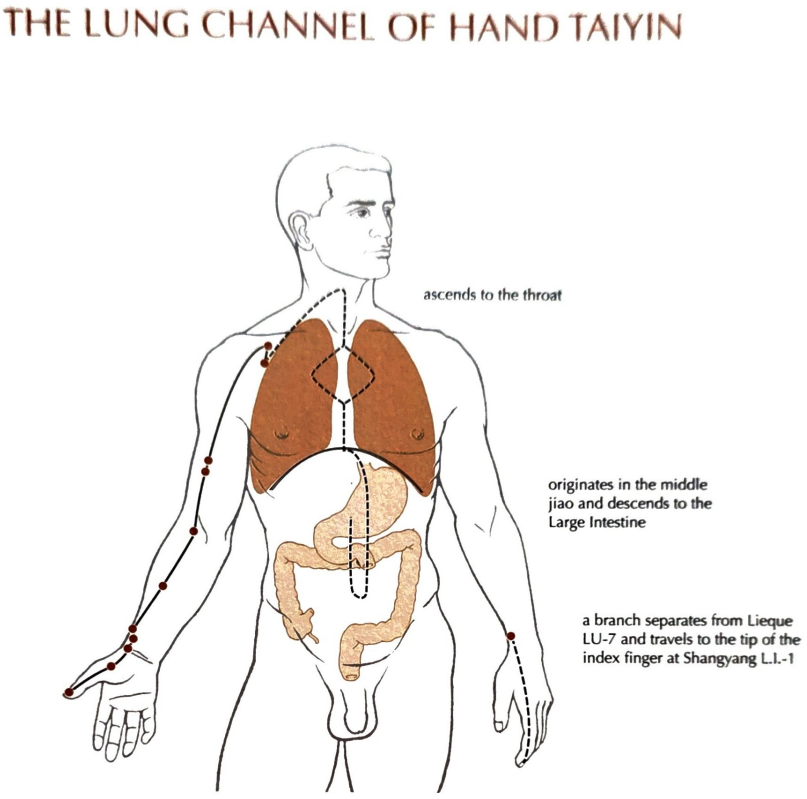
Point	Category	Clinical Use
LU7	Luo + Confluent + Command	Opens Ren Mai; commands head/neck; cough, headache, stiff neck -- most loaded point on LU
LU9	Yuan-Source + Shu-Stream	Radial pulse site; tonifies Lung Qi, chronic cough/asthma
LU5	He-Sea	Clears heat, descends rebellious Lung Qi; cough, asthma, acute throat
LU1	Front-Mu (own)	Chest fullness, grief/sadness, cough -- diagnostic point for Lung
LU11	Jing-Well	Sore throat, fever, loss of consciousness -- emergency point

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- LU1 is the Lung's own Front-Mu -- most channels' Front-Mu sits elsewhere; this is an unusual, high-yield exam fact.
- LU and LI have an internal-organ link through the Middle Jiao/Stomach -- cough unresponsive to normal treatment can respond to LI points, and vice versa for constipation.
- LU7 carries THREE roles at once (Luo + Confluent opening Ren Mai + Command head/neck) -- one of the most heavily-loaded points in the whole course.
- Point-count asymmetry is a pattern, not an exception: LI (20 pts) nearly doubles LU (11 pts) -- the same pattern repeats HT(9)/SI(19).

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Lung Meridian

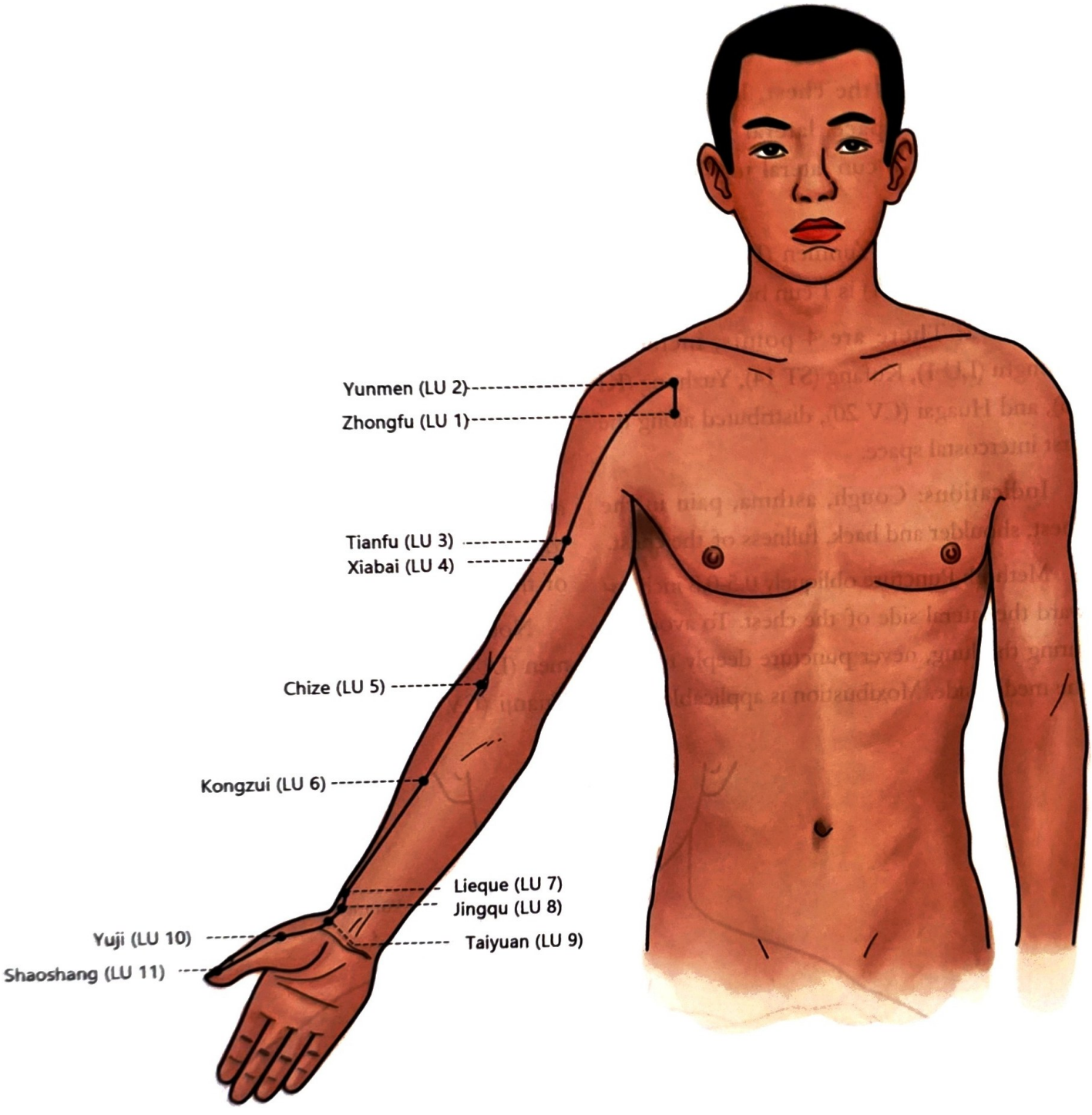
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Originates in the Middle Burner (Middle Jiao), descends to connect with the LARGE INTESTINE (interior-exterior pairing)
2. Turns back, winds along the upper orifice of the stomach, passes through the diaphragm, enters the LUNG (pertaining organ)
3. From the 'Lung system' (the portion communicating with the throat), emerges transversely below the clavicle at LU1 Zhongfu
4. Descends along the medial aspect of the upper arm, passing IN FRONT of the HT and PC channels
5. Reaches the cubital fossa (elbow), continues down the anterior border of the radial side of the forearm
6. Enters 'cunkou' at the wrist -- the radial artery pulse-taking site -- passing LU9 Taiyuan
7. Along the thenar eminence, radial border, ending at the medial side of the thumb tip, LU11 Shaoshang
8. BRANCH: emerges from LU7 Lieque near the wrist, runs directly to the radial side of the index finger tip -> LI1 Shangyang, linking to LARGE INTESTINE

LU -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Lung Meridian

LI -- LARGE INTESTINE

20 pts | Metal | Yang | 5-7 AM | Hand -> Head

Category	Detail
Full name	Large Intestine Meridian of Hand-Yangming
Pertains / Connects	Large Intestine / Lung
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL25 Dachangshu / ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel)
Yuan-Source	LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy
Luo-Connecting	LI6 Pianli
He-Sea	LI11 Quchi
Xi-Cleft	LI7 Wenliu
Confluent	none
Command Point	LI4 -- face/mouth
Crossing Points	crosses GV14, ST/SI region near shoulder/neck
First / Last Point	LI1 Shangyang / LI20 Yingxiang

FUNCTIONS

- Governs transmission and transformation -- moves waste through the digestive tract
- Connects to LOWER teeth and gums specifically (upper teeth/gums = ST channel)
- Back-Shu: BL25 Dachangshu | Front-Mu: ST25 Tianshu (on the ST channel, not LI's own)
- Has nearly DOUBLE the points of LU (20 vs. 11) despite being the Yang/Fu partner
- Has multiple crossing points (GV14, GV26, ST4, and an SI point near the face) -- more than most channels covered early in the course

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Toothache (especially LOWER teeth) -- near-immediate relief documented for LI4
- Abdominal pain, borborygmus, constipation or diarrhea
- Constipation unresponsive to normal treatment can respond to LU points (interior-exterior pair)
- Sore/swollen throat, nasal problems, facial paralysis, loss of smell
- Pain along the channel: index finger, wrist, forearm, shoulder, neck

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

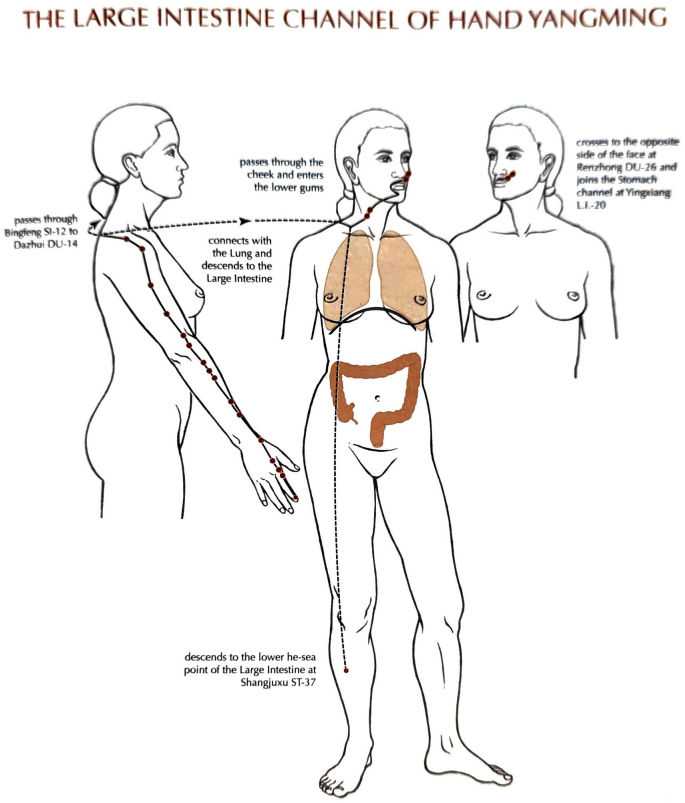
Point	Category	Clinical Use
LI4	Yuan-Source + Command (face/mouth)	FORBIDDEN in pregnancy; near-immediate toothache relief; general analgesic point
LI11	He-Sea	Clears heat, especially heat in the Blood; fever, skin disorders, hypertension
LI20	Last point, crossing to ST	Nasal congestion, loss of smell, facial paralysis
LI1	Jing-Well	Sore throat, fever, loss of consciousness

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- LI4 Hegu and toothache: near-immediate relief of lower-tooth pain is a real, citable clinical application.
- The interior-exterior pair in practice: cough that won't resolve can respond to LI points; constipation that won't resolve can respond to LU points.
- Upper vs. lower teeth is one of the most commonly tested facial-anatomy facts: LI = LOWER teeth/gums, ST = UPPER.
- Point-count asymmetry: LI (20) nearly doubles LU (11) -- the Yang/Fu channel consistently carries more points than its Yin/Zang partner.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Large Intestine Meridian

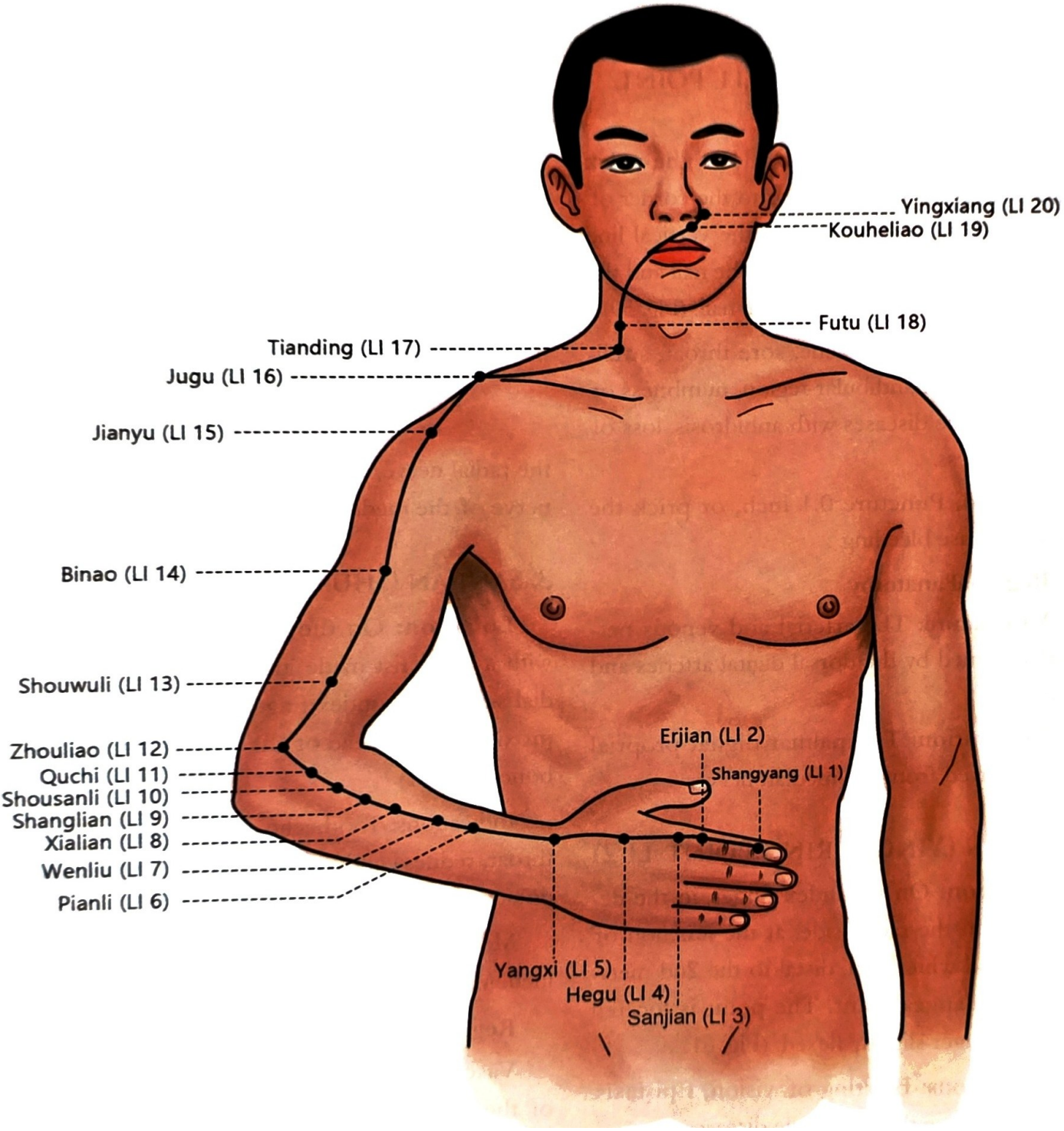
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Begins at the radial side of the tip of the index finger, LI1 Shangyang -- same finger where LU's branch terminates
2. Runs upward along the radial side of the index finger, through the web between the 1st/2nd metacarpal bones (LI4 Hegu)
3. Dips into the depression between the extensor pollicis longus/brevis tendons, follows the lateral-anterior forearm to the lateral elbow, up to the shoulder (LI15 Jianyu)
4. Along the anterior border of the acromion, ascends to C7 (GV14 Dazhui) -- the meeting point of ALL SIX Yang channels of hand and foot
5. Descends to the supraclavicular fossa, connects internally with the LUNG, passes through the diaphragm, PERTAINS Large Intestine
6. BRANCH: from the supraclavicular fossa, ascends the neck, passes through the cheek, enters the gums of the LOWER teeth
7. Curves around the upper lip, CROSSES to the opposite side at the philtrum (GV26 area) -- left meridian goes right, right goes left
8. Ends beside the nostril at LI20 Yingxiang, where LI links with the STOMACH meridian of Foot-Yangming

LI -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Large Intestine Meridian

ST -- STOMACH

45 pts | Earth | Yang | 7-9 AM | Head -> Foot

Category	Detail
Full name	Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming
Pertains / Connects	Stomach / Spleen
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL21 Weishu / CV12 Zhongwan
Yuan-Source	ST42 Chongyang
Luo-Connecting	ST40 Fenglong
He-Sea	ST36 Zusanli
Xi-Cleft	ST34 Liangqiu
Confluent	none
Command Point	ST36 -- abdomen; Lower He-Sea ST37 (LI) / ST39 (SI)
Crossing Points	11, mostly on the face/head (LI20, BL1, GB3/4/6, SP1, GV24, GV26, CV12/13/24)
First / Last Point	LI20 Yingxiang is the true origin; ST1 Chengqi / ST45 Lidui

FUNCTIONS

- Governs "reception and ripening" of food -- the root of Postnatal Qi and Blood production together with SP
- Only channel to pass through the NIPPLE -- ST17 Ruzhong is a landmark only, never needled
- True pathway origin is LI20 (a crossing point of the LI channel) -- ST1 is only the first NUMBERED point
- Descends turbid Qi (opposite of SP, which ascends the clear) -- ST pathology often shows REBELLIOUS/ascending symptoms (vomiting, belching, nausea)
- Has 11 crossing points, most of them on the face and head (LI20, BL1, GB3/4/6, SP1, GV24, GV26, CV12/13/24)

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Facial pain, toothache (UPPER teeth specifically), facial paralysis/deviation, sore throat
- Mania/agitation along the Yangming excess-heat pattern (classic "Yangming madness")
- Mastitis and breast disorders (ST passes directly through breast tissue)
- Abdominal distension, pain, vomiting, belching -- Stomach-Qi rebelling upward
- Pain along the channel: face, chest, abdomen, anterior leg, dorsum of foot

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

Point	Category	Clinical Use
ST36	He-Sea + Command Abdomen + Lower He-Sea (own)	#1 tonic point in TCM; immunity, anti-inflammation, digestion
ST40	Luo-Connecting	#1 phlegm-resolving point in all of TCM
ST25	Front-Mu of LARGE INTESTINE (not Stomach)	diarrhea, constipation, borborygmus
ST44	Ying-Spring	Yangming heat; UPPER toothache specifically
ST34	Xi-Cleft	ACUTE stomach pain, gastritis
ST9	Window of Heaven	blood pressure, goiter -- carotid region, needle with care

Point	Category	Clinical Use
ST42	Yuan-Source	dorsum of foot, the highest point on the foot

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- ST begins at LI20, not ST1 -- ST1 Chengqi is only the first NUMBERED point along the pathway.
- ST25 is the Front-Mu of the LARGE INTESTINE, not Stomach -- Stomach's own Front-Mu is CV12 Zhongwan, on a completely different channel.
- UPPER teeth/gums = ST channel. LOWER teeth/gums = LI channel -- a direct, frequently-tested distinction.
- ONLY the Stomach channel passes through the nipple -- nipple pain or numbness points to ST.
- LI hands off to ST, not to SP -- a classic circuit-continuity trap when reciting the Outer Circuit.

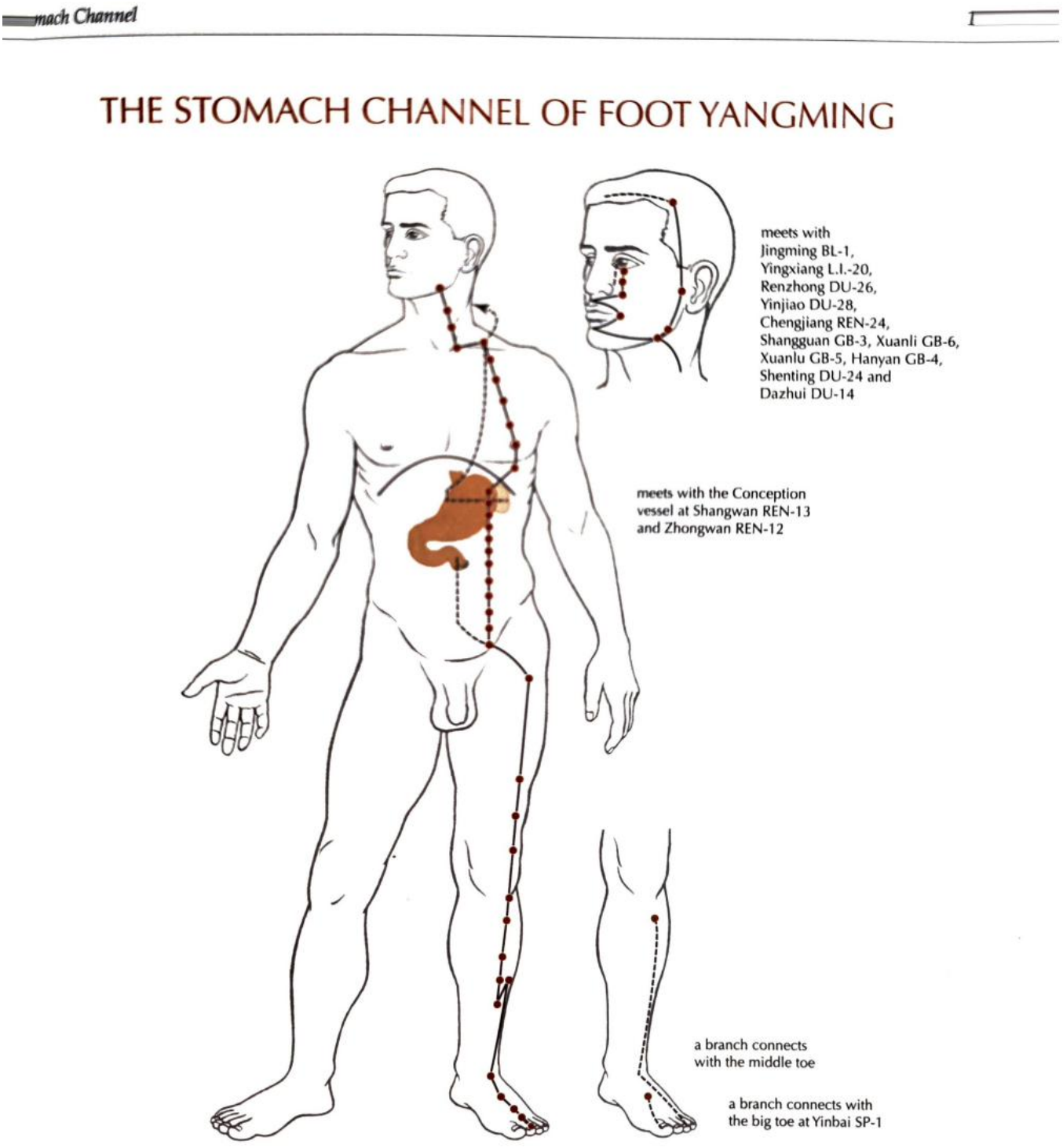
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Starts at the lateral side of the ala nasi at LI20 Yingxiang -- the true origin is INTERNAL at LI20 (LI links to ST here). ST1 Chengqi is only the first NUMBERED point on ST's own external line. ST has SIX branches
2. BRANCH 1 -- the face: ascends to the bridge of the nose and meets BL1 Jingming; turns down the lateral nose to ST1, enters the UPPER gum; re-emerges, curves around the lips and descends to CV24 Chengjiang in the mentolabial groove
3. BRANCH 1 (cont.): runs back across the lower cheek (ST5 Daying), winds along the angle of the mandible (ST6 Jiache), ascends in front of the ear through GB3 Shangguan, follows the anterior hairline (GB4, GB6, ST8) and reaches the forehead at GV24 Shenting
4. BRANCH 2 -- the facial branch (INTERNAL): emerges in front of ST5, runs down the neck to ST9 Renying, along the throat, into the supraclavicular fossa (ST12), down through the diaphragm; PERTAINS to the Stomach and CONNECTS with the Spleen
5. BRANCH 3 -- the straight portion (EXTERNAL): from the supraclavicular fossa runs down through the NIPPLE (only the Stomach channel passes through the nipple), descends beside the umbilicus (ST19-ST29), and enters the lateral lower abdomen at ST30 Qichong
6. BRANCH 4 -- the long branch: begins at the LOWER orifice of the stomach, descends inside the abdomen (CV12, CV13) and joins the straight portion at ST30; runs down the anterior thigh through ST31 Biguan and ST32 Futu to the knee
7. BRANCH 4 (cont.): continues down the anterior border of the lateral aspect of the tibia, across the dorsum of the foot, and ends at the lateral side of the tip of the 2nd toe, ST45 Lidui (Jing-Well) -- the LAST point
8. BRANCH 5 -- the tibial branch: leaves at ST36 Zusanli, 3 cun below the knee, and enters the lateral side of the middle toe (the only point on this branch is ST36)
9. BRANCH 6 -- the foot branch: leaves the dorsum of the foot at ST42 Chongyang and ends at the medial side of the tip of the great toe, SP1 Yinbai, where ST links with the SPLEEN channel

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

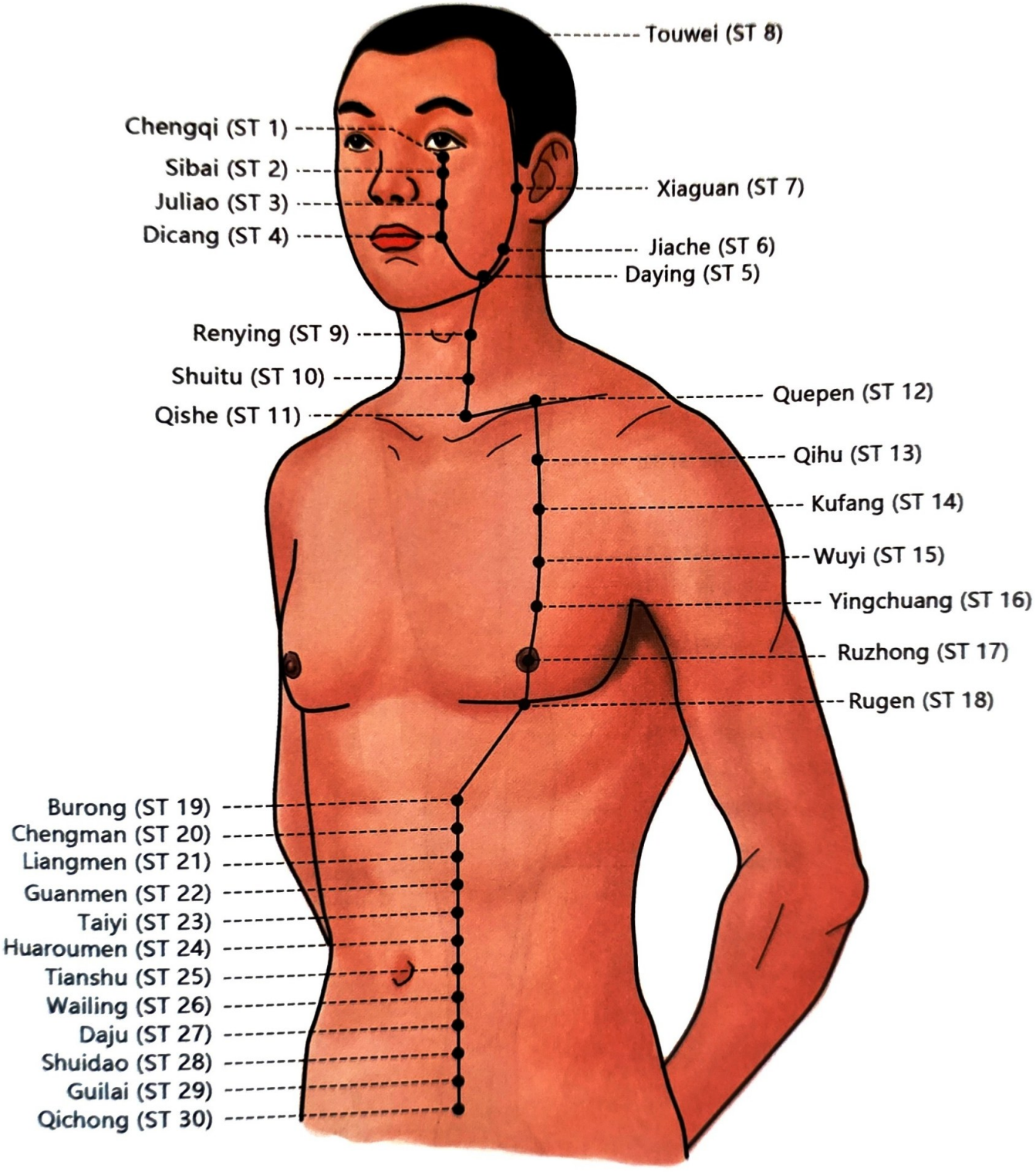
Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Stomach Meridian

ST -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP -- part 1

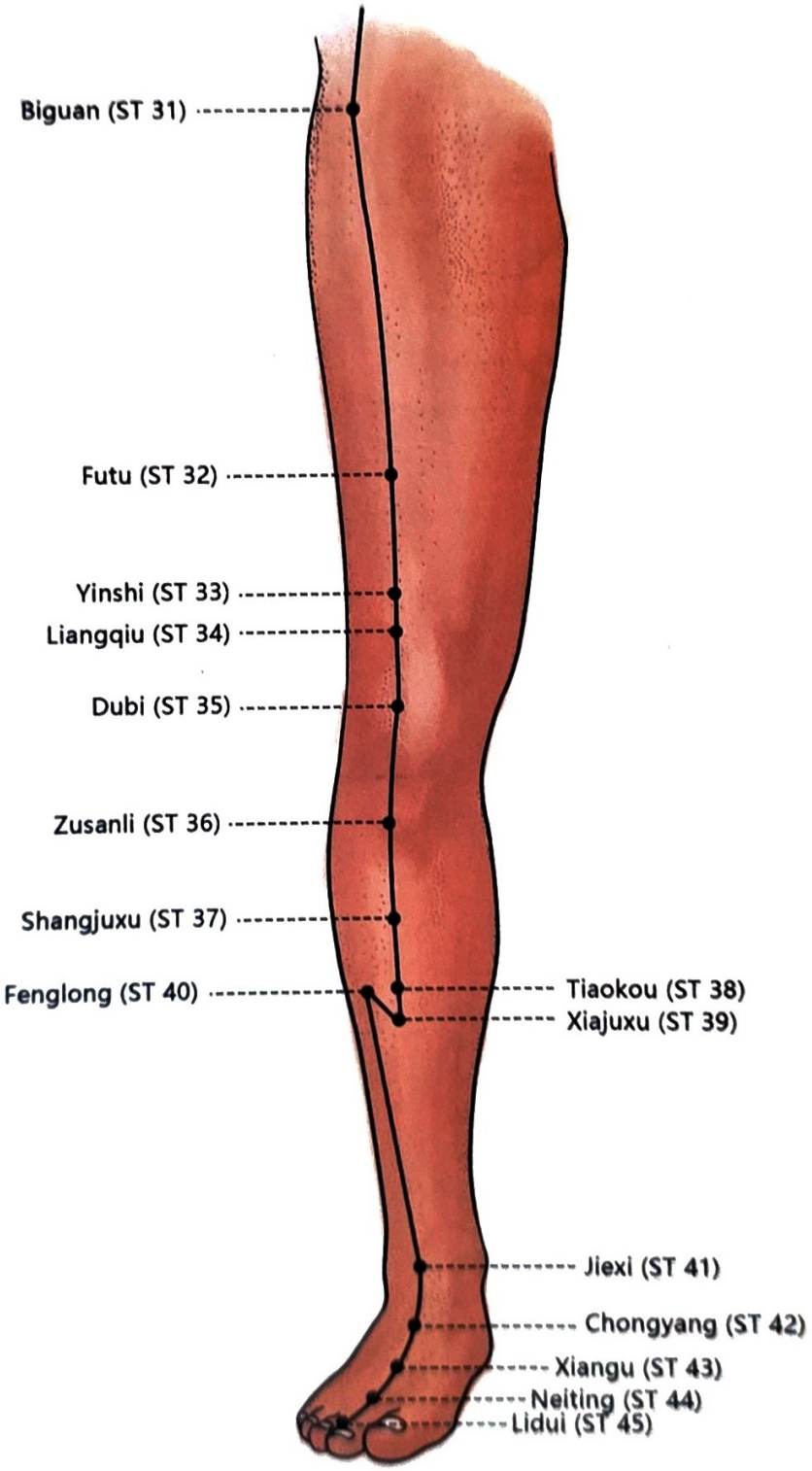
Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Stomach Meridian

ST -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP -- part 2 (leg and foot)

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Stomach Meridian

SP -- SPLEEN

21 pts | Earth | Yin | 9-11 AM | Foot -> Chest

Category	Detail
Full name	Spleen Meridian of Foot-Taiyin
Pertains / Connects	Spleen / Stomach
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL20 Pishu / LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel)
Yuan-Source	SP3 Taibai
Luo-Connecting	SP4 Gongsun
He-Sea	SP9 Yinlingquan
Xi-Cleft	SP8 Diji
Confluent	SP4 -- opens Chong Mai (paired w/ PC6)
Command Point	Great Luo SP21 Dabao
Crossing Points	6 -- abdomen/chest (CV3, CV4, CV10, GB24, LR14, LU1)
First / Last Point	SP1 Yinbai / SP21 Dabao

FUNCTIONS

- Governs transportation and transformation of food/fluids -- produces Qi and Blood together with ST
- Controls the Blood -- keeps Blood within the vessels (SP deficiency -> bleeding disorders)
- ONLY channel that spreads across the LOWER surface of the tongue
- Ascends the clear (opposite of ST, which descends the turbid) -- SP pathology often shows sinking/prolapse symptoms
- Governs the muscles and four limbs; opens into the mouth, manifests in the lips

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Abdominal distension, poor appetite, loose stools, fatigue/heaviness of the limbs
- Irregular or heavy menstruation, easy bruising, bleeding disorders (Spleen not controlling Blood)
- Pain along the channel: medial leg, knee, groin
- Edema, especially of the lower body (SP governs transformation of dampness)
- Prolapse-type conditions (organ prolapse, hemorrhoids) -- Sinking of Spleen Qi

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

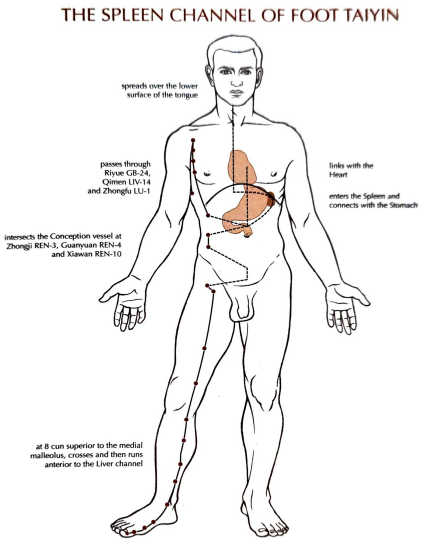
Point	Category	Clinical Use
SP6	3-Yin Crossing (SP/LR/KI)	gynecological disorders; FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY
SP9	He-Sea	#1 dampness-resolving point in TCM; edema, knee disorders
SP10	Sea of Blood	skin disorders, itching, irregular menstruation
SP4	Luo-Connecting + Confluent	opens Chong Mai; pairs with PC6
SP3	Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source	tonifies Spleen Qi; heaviness, fatigue
SP8	Xi-Cleft	ACUTE dysmenorrhea, abdominal pain
SP21	Great (Major) Luo	whole-body pain, weak limbs

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- The 8-cun crossover with LR is the ONLY distribution exception among all 12 meridians -- below 8 cun above the medial malleolus SP runs posterior to LR; above it, SP moves anterior.
- SP connects internally to HT, not to LI -- SP hands off to Heart at the end of the Outer Circuit, opening the Inner/Posterior Circuit.
- The Front-Mu of Spleen is LR13 Zhangmen -- it sits on the LIVER channel, not SP's own pathway.
- ONLY the Spleen channel spreads over the LOWER surface of the tongue (Kidney reaches the ROOT of the tongue -- a related but distinct fact).
- SP4 opens the Chong Mai specifically -- not Ren, not Du -- paired with PC6.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Spleen Meridian

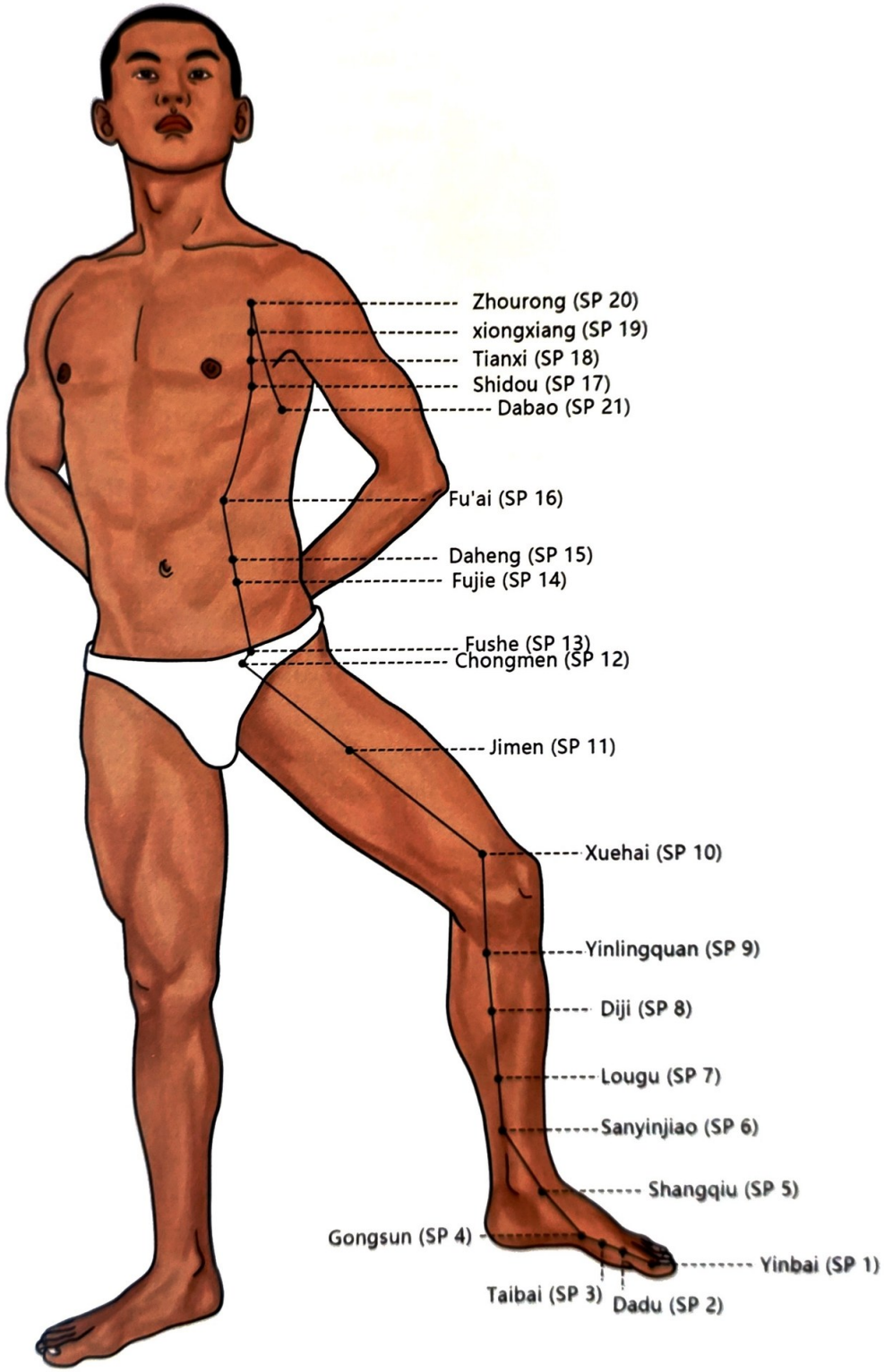
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Begins at the tip of the big toe, SP1 Yinbai (Jing-Well) -- where the ST foot branch arrives. SP runs head-ward, FOOT to abdomen/chest. SP has THREE branches
2. BRANCH 1 (main course): runs along the medial aspect of the foot at the junction of the red and white skin, then ascends in front of the medial malleolus (SP5 on the slide) up the medial leg, following the POSTERIOR aspect of the tibia
3. THE ONE EXCEPTION: at 8 cun above the medial malleolus SP crosses IN FRONT of the Liver channel. Below that point the Liver is anterior and SP is in the middle line; above it SP returns to the normal Taiyin ANTERIOR position
4. BRANCH 1 (cont.): passes up the anterior medial aspect of the knee and thigh and enters the abdomen (SP12, SP13, CV3, CV4, SP14, SP15); PERTAINS to the Spleen and CONNECTS with the Stomach (CV10, SP16, GB24, LR14)
5. BRANCH 2 (ascending from the stomach): passes up through the diaphragm, runs alongside the esophagus, reaches the ROOT of the tongue and spreads over its LOWER surface -- SP is the only channel that spreads over the lower surface of the tongue
6. BRANCH 3 (internal link to the next channel): from the stomach goes up through the diaphragm and pours into the HEART, linking with the Heart Meridian of Hand-Shaoyin (this is how the Anterior Circuit hands off to the Posterior Circuit; LU1 is a crossing point on this link)
7. EXTERNAL course ends at SP21 Dabao (Major Luo-Connecting point of the Spleen) on the lateral chest. On the trunk SP lies MORE lateral than the Stomach line (about 6 cun from the midline vs 4 cun for ST). SP has 21 points

SP -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Spleen Meridian

HT -- HEART

9 pts | Fire | Yin | 11 AM-1 PM | Chest -> Hand

Category	Detail
Full name	Heart Meridian of Hand-Shaoyin
Pertains / Connects	Heart / Small Intestine
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL15 Xinshu / CV14 Juque
Yuan-Source	HT7 Shenmen
Luo-Connecting	HT5 Tongli
He-Sea	HT3 Shaohai
Xi-Cleft	HT6 Yinxi
Confluent	none
Command Point	none
Crossing Points	none (fewest of any primary channel, tied w/ PC)
First / Last Point	HT1 Jiquan / HT9 Shaochong

FUNCTIONS

- Governs Blood and the vessels ("the Heart controls the pulse")
- Has ZERO crossing points -- the only primary channel (tied with PC) with none
- Houses the Shen (spirit/mind) -- the Heart "stores the Shen"
- Fewest total points of any primary channel (9)
- Back-Shu: BL15 Xinshu | Front-Mu: CV14 Juque

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Palpitations, chest pain (Heart itself)
- Mental-emotional disturbance: anxiety, mania, incoherent speech, loss of consciousness (Shen disturbance)
- Heat in the palms, dry throat, thirst
- Insomnia, excessive dreaming, poor memory
- Pain along the channel: axilla, medial arm, elbow, forearm to little finger

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

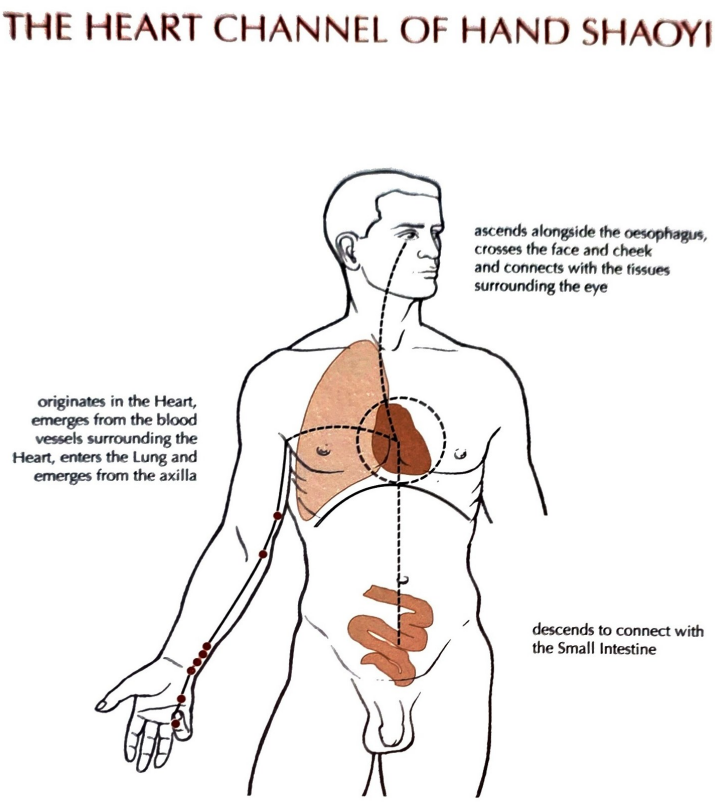
Point	Category	Clinical Use
HT7	Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source	calms Shen; #1 point for anxiety, insomnia, palpitations
HT3	He-Sea	clears heart fire; fear, arm pain along the channel
HT6	Xi-Cleft	night sweats, acute heart pain
HT9	Jing-Well	emergency point: severe heart pain, palpitations, revives consciousness
HT5	Luo-Connecting	links to SI; treats disorders of both channels

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- HT is the smallest channel (9 points) but governs the Shen -- clinically central for anxiety, insomnia, and emotional disorders despite its small point count.
- Primary Fire (HT/SI) vs. Ministerial Fire (PC/SJ): do not conflate these -- they open different circuits (Posterior vs. Middle).
- HT has ZERO crossing points -- the only one of the 12 primary channels with none on its external pathway, tied with PC.
- HT7 Shenmen literally means "Spirit Gate" -- as both Shu-Stream and Yuan-Source, it's the single most important point for calming an agitated Shen.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Heart Meridian

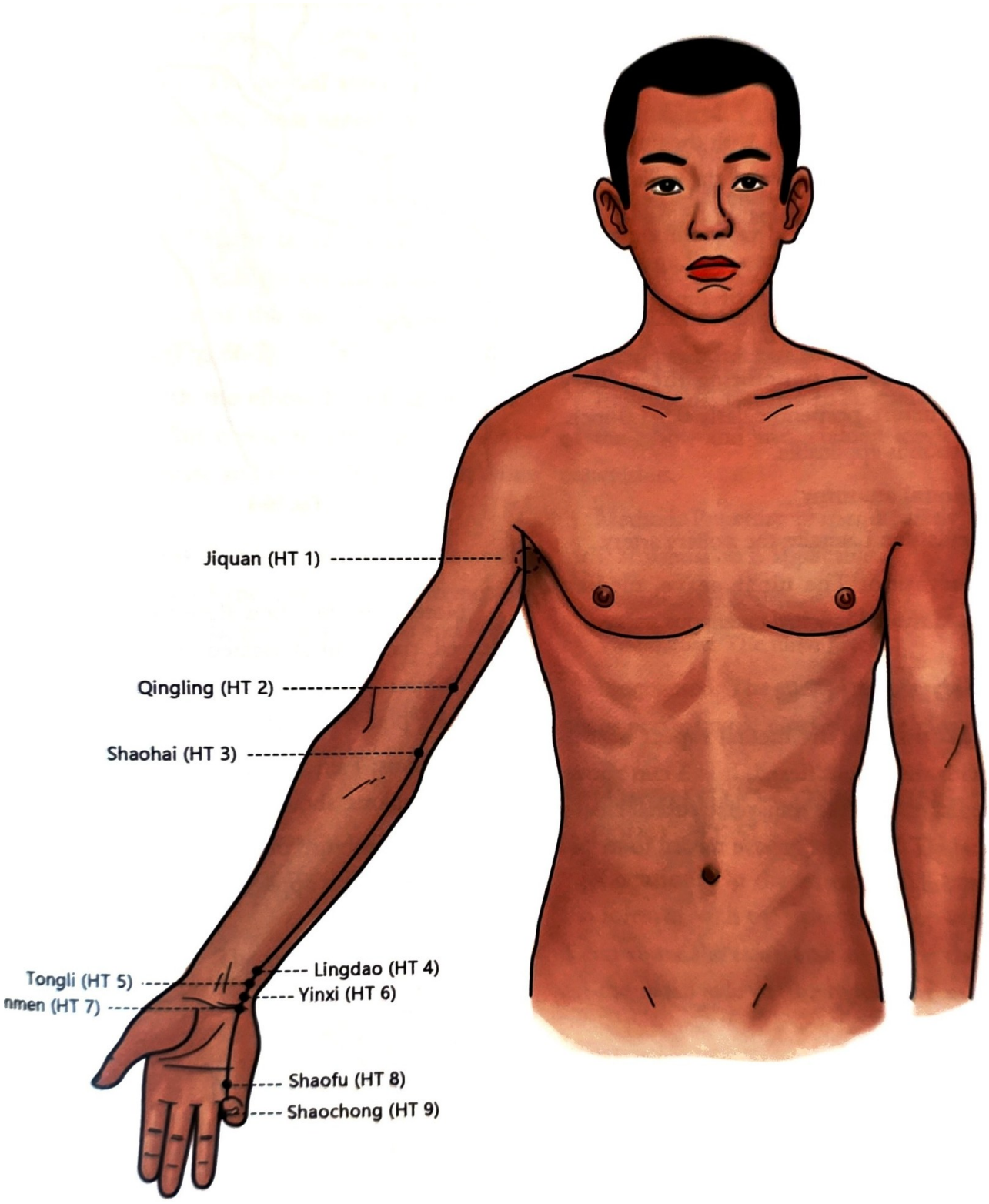
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Originates in the Heart, emerges from the system of blood vessels surrounding the Heart
2. Descends through the diaphragm to connect with the SMALL INTESTINE (interior-exterior pairing)
3. BRANCH: ascends alongside the esophagus, crosses the face and cheek, connects with the tissues surrounding the eye (the 'eye system')
4. The main external pathway emerges from the axilla at HT1 Jiquan
5. Descends along the postero-medial aspect of the arm (posterior to LU and PC channels) to the elbow at HT3 Shaohai
6. Continues along the medial/ulnar aspect of the forearm to the wrist at HT7 Shenmen (pisiform bone)
7. Travels through the palm along the radial side of the little finger
8. Ends at HT9 Shaochong, radial tip of the little finger nail -- hands off to SMALL INTESTINE

HT -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Heart Meridian

SI -- SMALL INTESTINE

19 pts | Fire | Yang | 1-3 PM | Hand -> Head

Category	Detail
Full name	Small Intestine Meridian of Hand-Taiyang
Pertains / Connects	Small Intestine / Heart
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL27 Xiaochangshu / CV4 Guanyuan
Yuan-Source	SI4 Wangu
Luo-Connecting	SI7 Zhizheng
He-Sea	SI8 Xiaohai
Xi-Cleft	SI6 Yanglao
Confluent	SI3 Houxi -- opens Du Mai (paired w/ BL62)
Command Point	none
Crossing Points	crosses GV14, cheek/eye region
First / Last Point	SI1 Shaoze / SI19 Tinggong

FUNCTIONS

- Governs "separation of the pure from the impure" in digestion (receives food from Stomach, separates nutrients from waste)
- Crosses BL1 and GB14 on its facial branches -- unlike HT, which has none
- Back-Shu: BL27 Xiaochangshu | Front-Mu: CV4 Guanyuan
- More than double HT's point count (19 vs. 9), same pattern as LU(11)/LI(20)
- SI3 opens the Du Mai (paired with BL62) -- the only confluent point on this channel

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Swelling of the cheek and neck, jaw pain, deafness, tinnitus
- Abdominal pain and distension, borborygmus, diarrhea or constipation
- Mental disorders -- SI's internal course also links to Shen disturbance via the Heart
- Pain along the postero-lateral shoulder, arm, and elbow; stiff neck, sore throat
- Excess breast milk / lactation problems

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

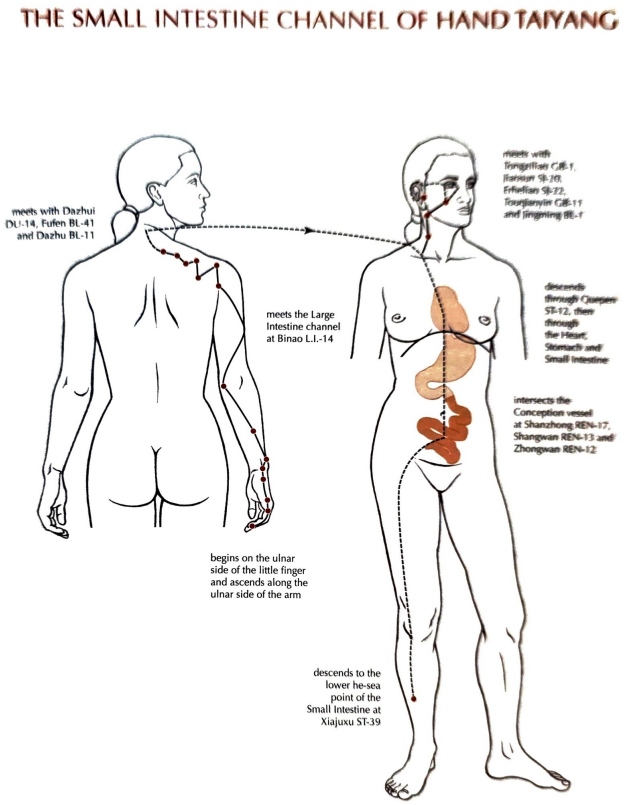
Point	Category	Clinical Use
SI3	Shu-Stream + Confluent	opens Du Mai (pairs with BL62); spine, neck, febrile disease
SI4	Yuan-Source	wrist/finger pain, febrile disease
SI8	He-Sea	elbow/arm disorders, mental-emotional Fire patterns
SI19	Last point	tinnitus, deafness, ear disorders
SI1	Jing-Well	excess breast milk / lactation problems

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- SI's Lower He-Sea sits on a DIFFERENT channel (ST39 Xiajuxu, on the Stomach channel) -- true for all six Fu organs.
- SI point count mirrors the LU/LI pattern: SI (19) more than doubles HT (9), just as LI (20) nearly doubles LU (11).
- SI3 Houxi is both Shu-Stream AND a Confluent point opening the Du Mai (paired with BL62) -- key for spine/neck disorders and febrile disease.
- The Posterior/Inner Circuit begins this pairing: HT (chest to hand) -> SI (hand to head), continuing next with BL and KI.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Small Intestine Meridian

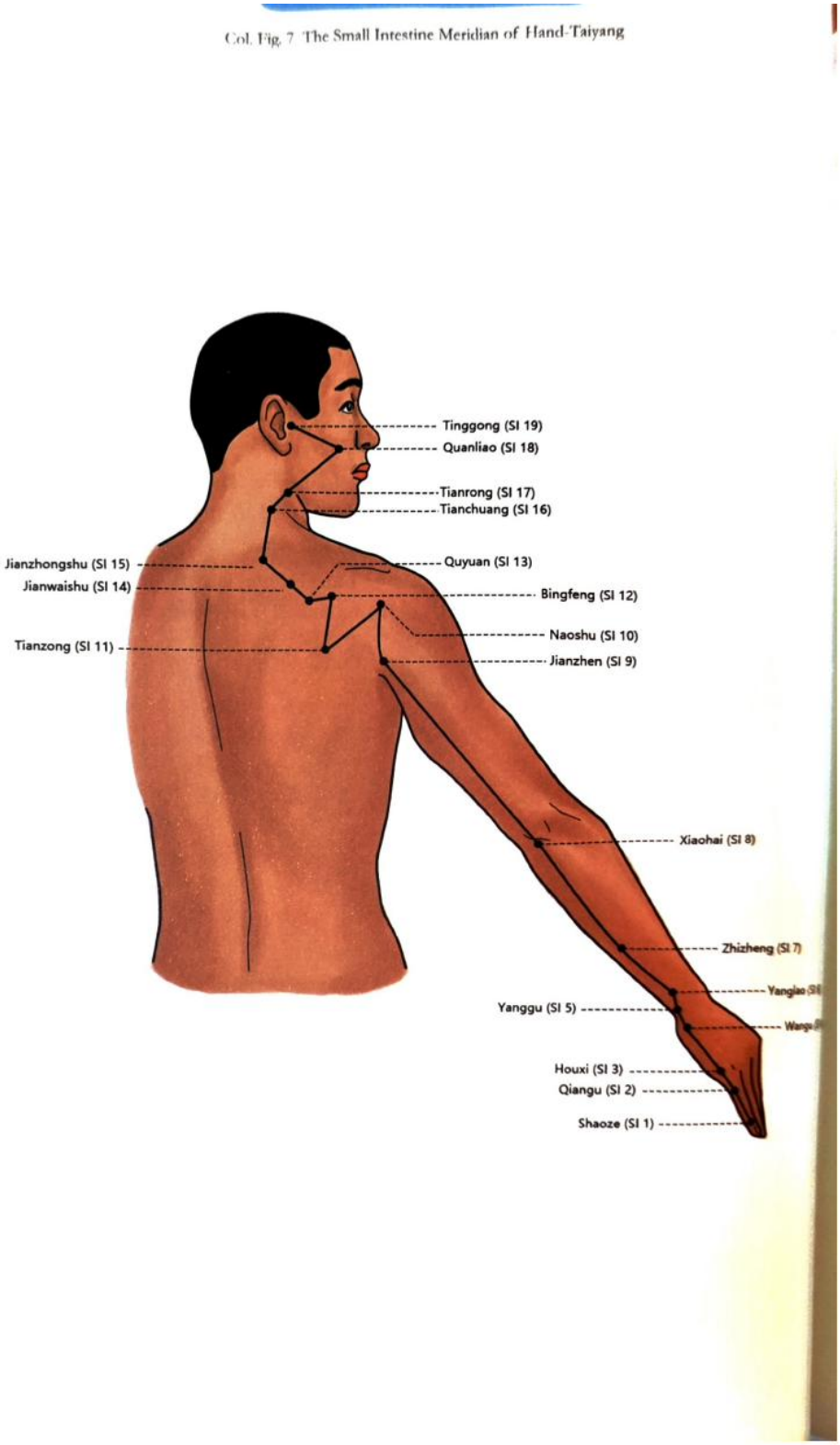
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Begins at SI1 Shaoze, ulnar side of the little finger tip -- where HT's branch terminates
2. Runs along the ulnar/dorsal aspect of the hand and forearm, through SI3 Houxi and SI5 Yanggu
3. Crosses the elbow at SI8 Xiaohai (He-Sea), ascends the posterior aspect of the upper arm
4. Circles the shoulder joint (SI9-SI10), zigzags across the scapula (SI11-SI13)
5. Crosses GV14 Dazhui at the top of the shoulder, enters the supraclavicular fossa
6. Descends internally to the HEART, through the diaphragm, reaches the Stomach, PERTAINS Small Intestine
7. BRANCH: from the neck, ascends the cheek to the outer canthus, enters the ear at SI19 Tinggong
8. SECOND BRANCH: from the cheek, ascends to the inner canthus (crosses BL1 Jingming), then to the cheekbone (crosses GB14 Yangbai)

SI -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Small Intestine Meridian

BL -- BLADDER

67 pts | Water | Yang | 3-5 PM | Head -> Foot

Category	Detail
Full name	Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang
Pertains / Connects	Bladder / Kidney
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL28 Pangguangshu (own) / CV3 Zhongji
Yuan-Source	BL64 Jinggu
Luo-Connecting	BL58 Feiyang
He-Sea	BL40 Weizhong (Command, back)
Xi-Cleft	BL63 Jinmen
Confluent	BL62 Shenmai -- opens Yang Qiao Mai (paired w/ SI3)
Command Point	BL40 -- back; hosts Back-Shu series BL13-BL28 for ALL 12 zang-fu organs
Crossing Points	14, shared with GV and GB, concentrated around the head
First / Last Point	BL1 Jingming / BL67 Zhiyin -- LARGEST channel in the body, 5 branches

FUNCTIONS

- Running-course function: two branches cross the head/brain -> headache; two long parallel lines run the ENTIRE back -> low back pain, sciatica-type pain
- Back-Shu bridge function: BL13-BL28 are the Back-Shu (transport) points for ALL 12 zang-fu organs
- Largest channel in the body: 67 points, 5 branches
- Internal-organ function: pertains to the Bladder -> urination disorders; acupuncture is particularly effective for urinary retention
- The two parallel lines on the back (1.5 cun and 3 cun lateral to the spine) run SIMULTANEOUSLY, not as a sequential loop

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Headache (from the two branches crossing the head/brain)
- Urination disorders -- retention, incontinence (Bladder's internal organ function)
- Eye disorders (BL1 region), difficult labor and fetal malposition (BL60, BL67)
- Low back pain, sciatica-type leg pain, calf pain, stiff leg (from the long parallel back lines)
- Virtually any organ disorder, treated via the corresponding Back-Shu point (BL13-BL28)

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

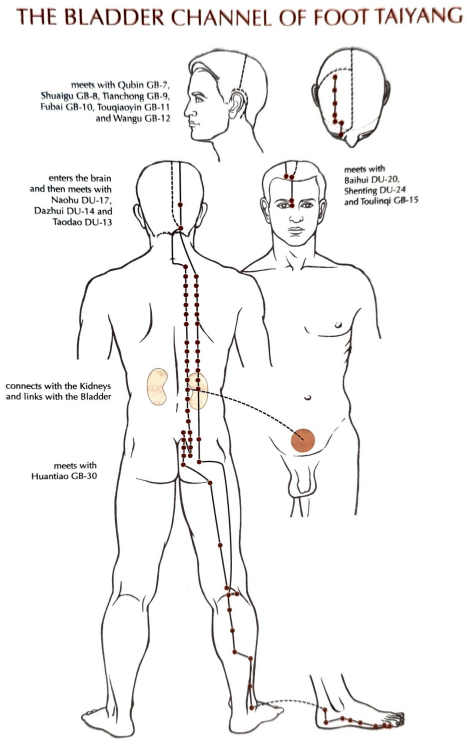
Point	Category	Clinical Use
BL40	He-Sea + Command (back)	clears summer-heat; low back pain
BL60	Jing-River	called the "aspirin of acupuncture" -- headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor
BL67	Jing-Well	corrects fetal malposition with moxibustion; labor induction
BL62	Confluent (Yang Qiao Mai)	sits close to BL63 Xi-Cleft below the lateral malleolus
BL13-BL28	Back-Shu series	organ transport points -- treat the corresponding zang-fu organ directly

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- TRAP: BL does NOT connect to the Lung -- its only internal connection is Kidney. Do not confuse with the Metal pathway.
- BL has 14 crossing points total, shared specifically with GV and GB, concentrated around the head.
- BL40 -> BL54 -> BL57 sequence matters for running-course quiz questions: popliteal crease -> upper thigh/sacrum -> calf belly (8 cun below BL40).
- The two parallel back lines run SIMULTANEOUSLY, confirmed directly in Q&A -- not a sequential up-then-down loop.
- BL7 (Tongtian) is NOT the vertex-joining point -- that's GV20 (Baihui), which BL merely joins at the vertex.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Bladder Meridian

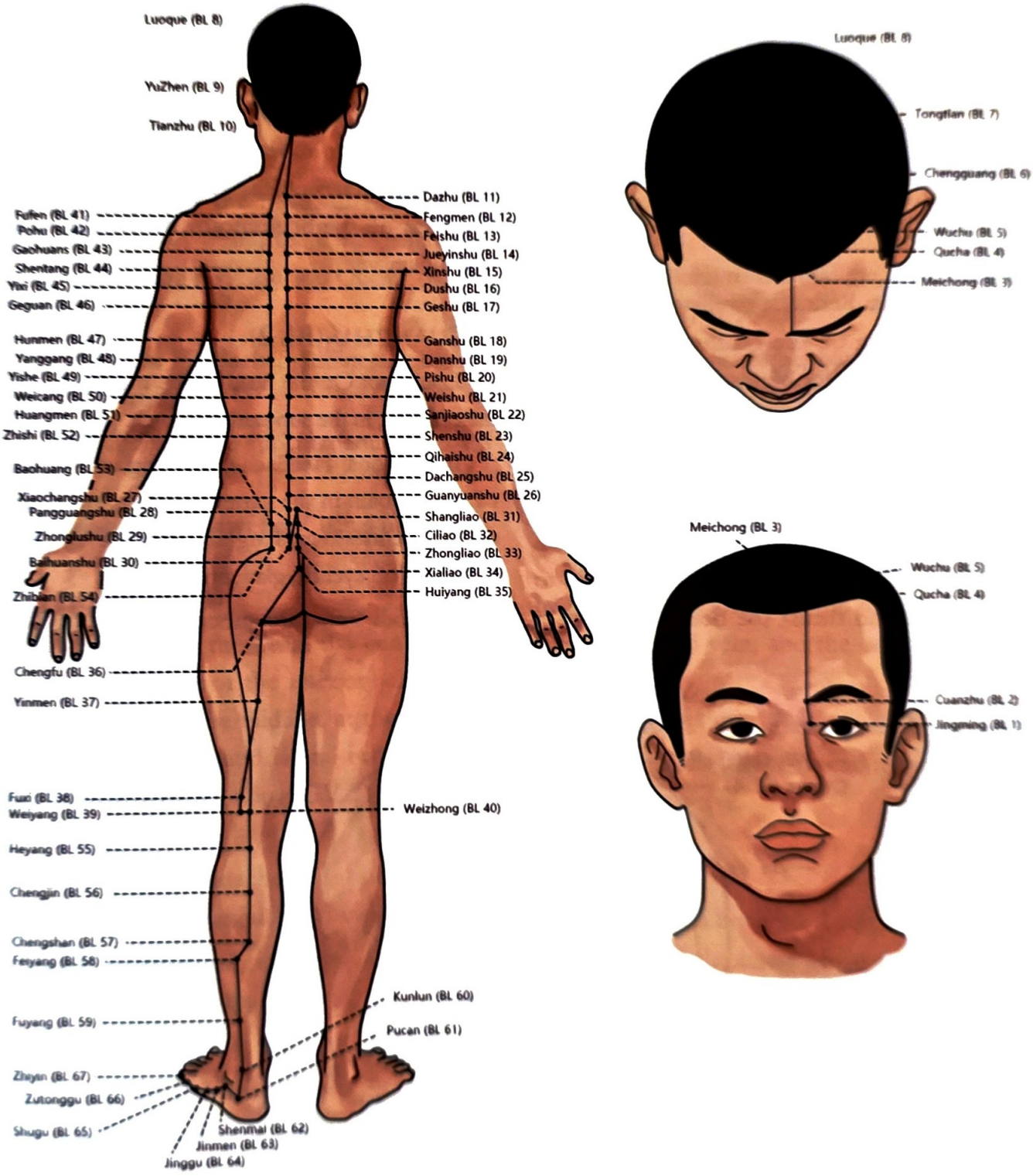
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Begins at the inner canthus, BL1 Jingming -- where SI's branch terminates
2. Ascends to the forehead, joins the Governing Vessel at the vertex (GV20) -- a branch splits off here to the temple
3. The straight portion continues internally from the vertex to communicate with the brain, then re-emerges to descend the posterior neck
4. Splits into TWO parallel lines running the full length of the back, alongside the spine, down to the lumbar region -- these run SIMULTANEOUSLY, not sequentially (confirmed directly by Dr. Zhang in Q&A)
5. The medial (1.5-cun) line enters the body at the lumbar region, connects internally with the KIDNEY, and PERTAINS Bladder
6. A branch from this internal connection descends through the buttock to the popliteal fossa
7. The lateral (3-cun) line runs alongside the medial line down the back, through the buttock (crossing GB30 Huantiao), down the posterior thigh, and MEETS the medial line's branch at the popliteal fossa
8. From the popliteal fossa, descends along the posterior calf, behind the lateral malleolus, along the 5th metatarsal, ending at the lateral tip of the little toe, BL67 Zhiyin -- hands off to KIDNEY

BL -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Bladder Meridian

KI -- KIDNEY

27 pts | Water | Yin | 5-7 PM | Foot -> Chest

Category	Detail
Full name	Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin
Pertains / Connects	Kidney / Bladder
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL23 Shenshu / GB25 Jingmen
Yuan-Source	KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role)
Luo-Connecting	KI4 Dazhong
He-Sea	KI10 Yingu
Xi-Cleft	KI5 Shuiquan
Confluent	KI6 Zhaohai -- opens Yin Qiao Mai (paired w/ LU7)
Command Point	none
Crossing Points	crosses SP at SP6 (Sanyinjiao); internally connects Lung, Liver, Heart
First / Last Point	KI1 Yongquan / KI27 Shufu -- 3 branches, terminates at root of tongue

FUNCTIONS

- Stores Essence (Jing) and grasps Qi (governs respiration at its root) -- treats asthma-type presentations via the internal Lung connection
- Terminates at the root of the tongue -> dry mouth, sore throat, tongue-root diagnostic signs
- Governs water metabolism, bone, marrow, and hearing
- Running-course function: pathway curves behind the medial malleolus/heel -> heel pain is a direct clinical cue
- 27 points, 3 branches -- fewer points than BL despite connecting to more internal organs (Lung, Liver, Heart, plus Bladder)

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Heel pain, lower back pain, weak knees (classic Kidney-deficiency pattern)
- Hearing disorders, bone/marrow disorders
- Asthma-type breathing difficulty (Kidney "grasps" Qi at its root)
- Dry mouth, sore throat, tongue-root symptoms
- Reproductive and urogenital disorders, edema (water metabolism)

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

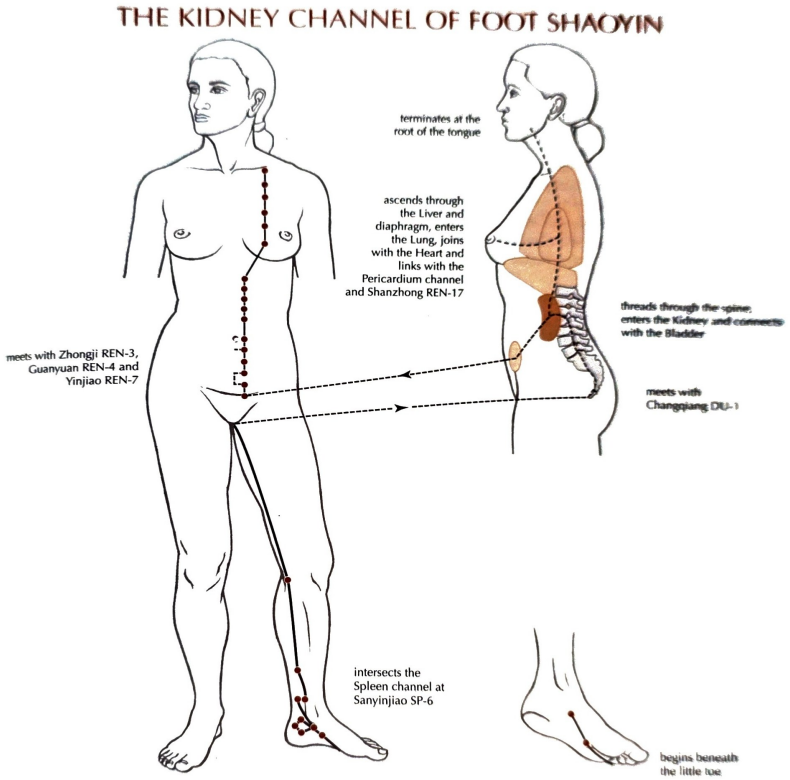
Point	Category	Clinical Use
KI1	Jing-Well	resuscitation, calms the spirit; used in hypertension
KI3	Yuan-Source + Shu-Stream	the key tonic point for Kidney Yin AND Yang
KI6	Confluent (Yin Qiao Mai)	insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation
KI7	Jing-River	tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats (often paired with HT6)
KI27	Last point	final point of the channel, inferior border of the clavicle -- links functionally into the chest before Pericardium begins

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- CLINICAL TEACHING POINT (verbatim emphasis): heel pain -- think Kidney first. The channel curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel.
- KI6 (Zhaohai) is the Confluent point opening the Yin Qiao Mai -- do not mix up with KI7, a Jing-River point with a different clinical profile.
- KI intersects the Spleen channel at SP6 (Sanyinjiao) on the medial leg -- a shared crossing point, not a KI-numbered point.
- Do not confuse KI3 (Taixi, Yuan-Source AND Shu-Stream -- dual role) with KI7 (Fuliu, Jing-River only), 2 cun proximal, anterior to the Achilles tendon.
- Week 5 completes the Posterior/Inner Circuit: HT+SI (Week 4) plus BL+KI (this week) form the full four-channel circuit.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Kidney Meridian

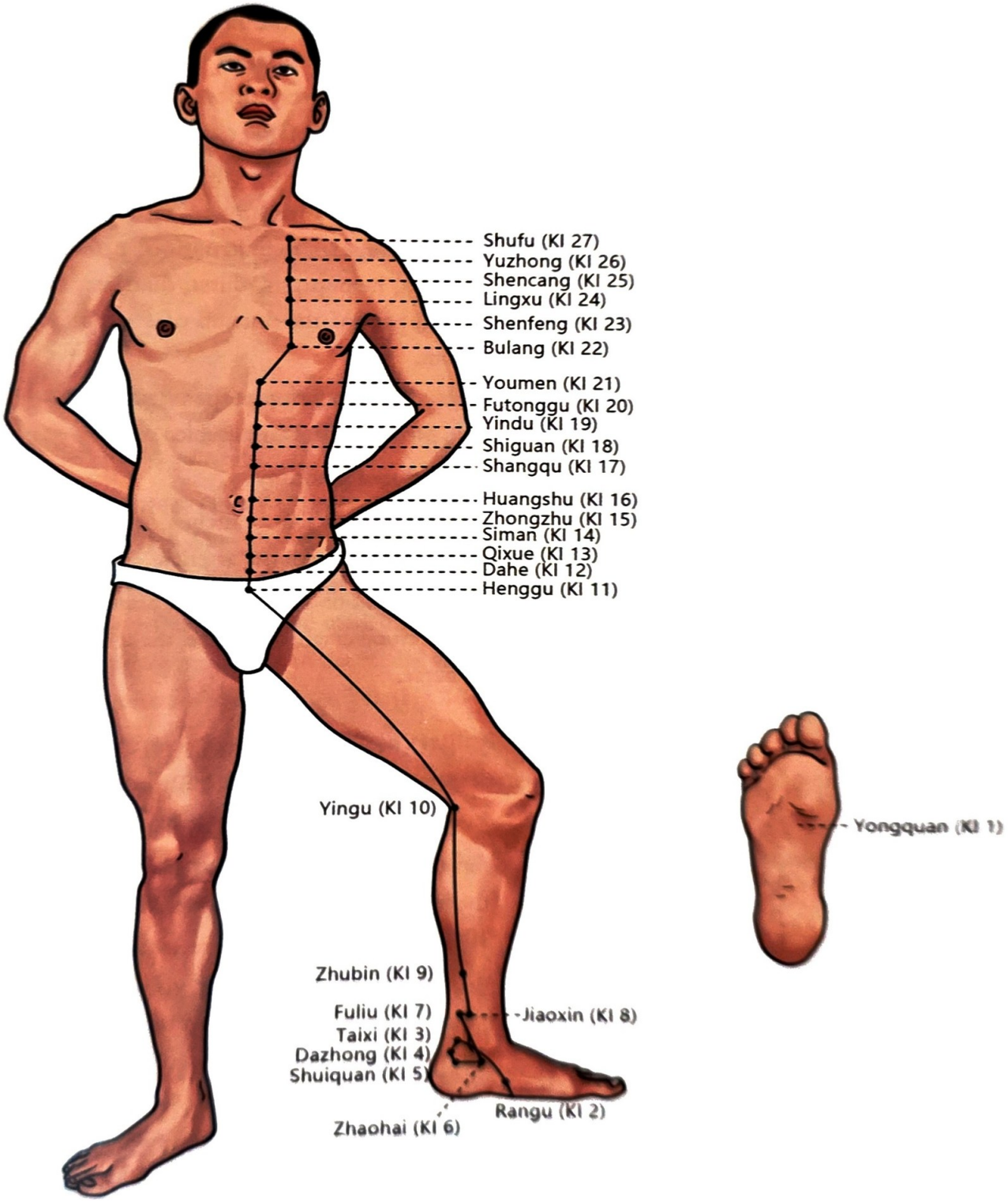
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Begins on the sole of the foot, below the little toe, at KI1 Yongquan -- where BL's course ends
2. Emerges below the tuberosity of the navicular bone, runs behind the medial malleolus, and enters the heel (this is why KI is the answer for heel pain -- its pathway curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel)
3. Ascends along the medial leg to the popliteal fossa, then up the postero-medial thigh, through the spine
4. Enters the body, connects internally with the BLADDER, PERTAINS Kidney
5. The straight portion continues upward from the Kidney, through the Liver and diaphragm, into the Lung, along the throat, terminating at the root of the tongue
6. BRANCH: separates from the Lung, connects with the Heart, continues into the chest -- links with the PERICARDIUM meridian of Hand-Jueyin
7. 67 points total (KI1 Yongquan to KI27 Shufu) -- despite fewer points than BL, KI connects internally with more organs (Kidney, Bladder, Liver, Lung, Heart) than almost any other channel

KI -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Kidney Meridian

PC -- PERICARDIUM

9 pts | Fire (Ministerial) | Yin | 7-9 PM | Chest -> Hand

Category	Detail
Full name	Pericardium Meridian of Hand-Jueyin
Pertains / Connects	Pericardium / San Jiao
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL14 Jueyinshu / CV17 Danzhong
Yuan-Source	PC7 Daling
Luo-Connecting	PC6 Neiguan
He-Sea	PC3 Quze
Xi-Cleft	PC4 Ximen
Confluent	PC6 -- opens Yin Wei Mai (paired w/ SP4) -- most-used confluent pairing in clinic
Command Point	none
Crossing Points	NONE -- exam trap, matches HT (only 2 primary channels w/ zero crossing points)
First / Last Point	PC1 Tianchi / PC9 Zhongchong

FUNCTIONS

- Protects the Heart -- shares many indications with HT (palpitations, chest/mental disorders)
- ZERO crossing points -- exam trap identical to HT (the only two channels with none)
- PC6 and PC8 are the most clinically-used points (safe, effective, hand/forearm); points on the chest (PC1) are used cautiously due to pneumothorax risk
- Governs Blood circulation and the vessels alongside HT; regulates sexual/reproductive function via the San Jiao lower-jiao connection
- Runs on the MIDDLE line of the arm, between LU (anterior) and HT (posterior)

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Palpitations, chest pain, angina-type presentations (shares much of HT's territory)
- Stomach/epigastric disorders (via PC6's action on the Middle Jiao)
- Insomnia, poor memory -- Shen-related, similar to HT
- Mental-emotional disturbance: anxiety, irritability, mania (PC8 Laogong is a classical Ghost Point for severe presentations)
- Nausea, vomiting, morning sickness (PC6 is a first-line anti-nausea point)

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

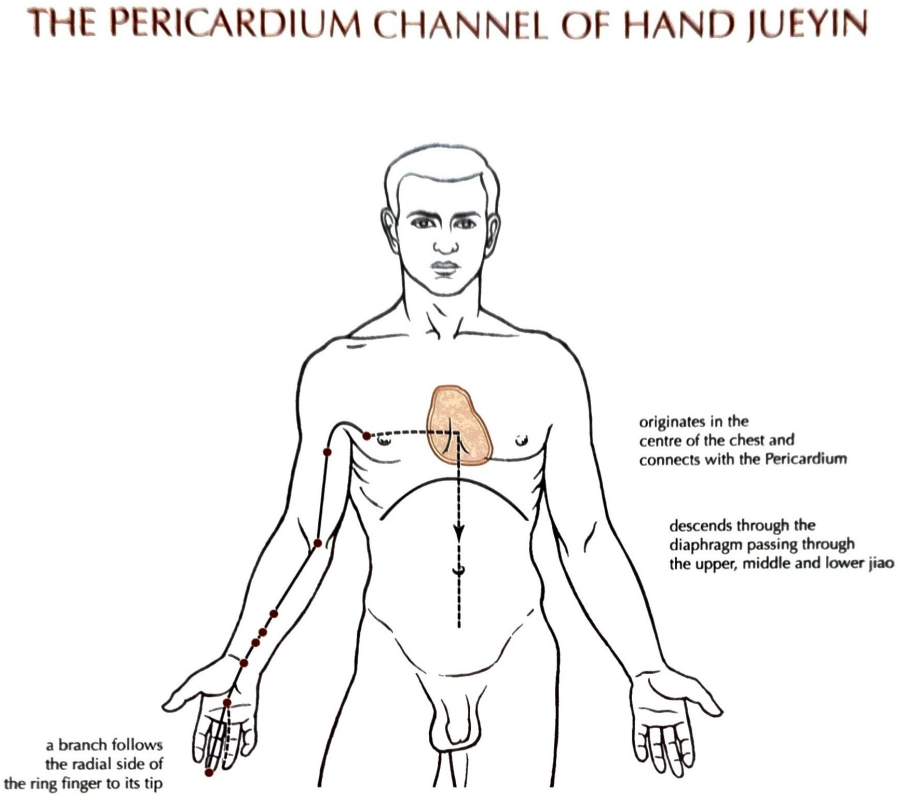
Point	Category	Clinical Use
PC6	Luo-Connecting + Confluent	opens Yin Wei Mai (paired w/ SP4) -- most-used confluent pairing in clinic; nausea, chest, stomach
PC7	Yuan-Source	wrist pulse-adjacent tonic point
PC3	He-Sea	clears heat, descends rebellious Qi from the chest
PC8	Ghost Point (classical)	one of Sun Simiao's 13 Ghost Points -- severe mental-emotional disturbance
PC4	Xi-Cleft	acute chest pain, acute palpitations

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- PC and HT are the ONLY two primary channels with zero crossing points -- a classic paired exam trap.
- PC runs the MIDDLE line of the arm -- between LU (anterior) and HT (posterior) -- an easy "which channel is this" positional trap.
- PC6 + SP4 is the most-used confluent pairing in clinic -- both Luo AND Confluent points, opening Yin Wei Mai + Chong Mai together.
- Ministerial Fire (PC/SJ) is a separate pairing from Primary Fire (HT/SI) -- different circuit, different clinical character.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Pericardium Meridian

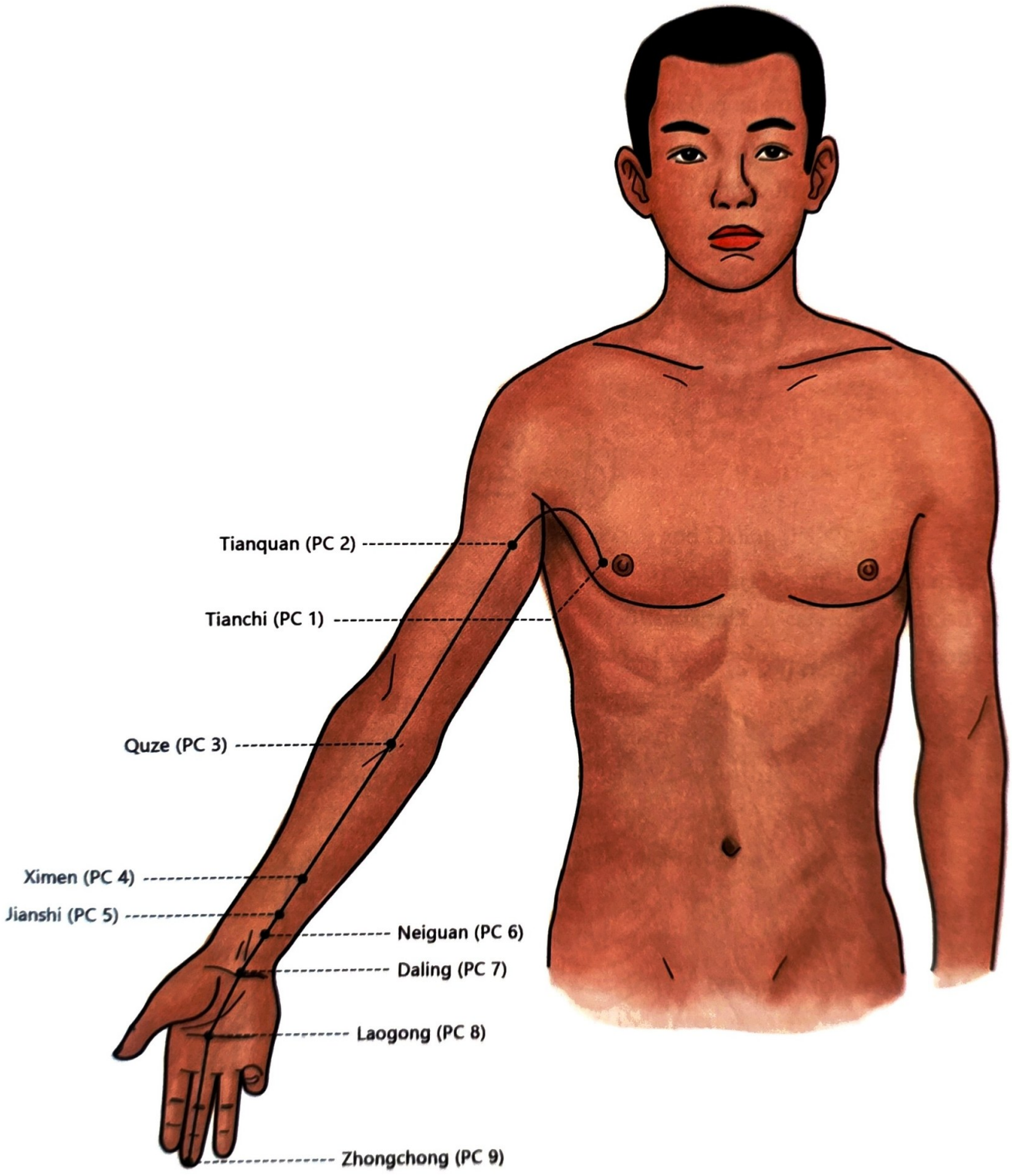
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Originates in the chest, emerges and enters its pertaining organ, the Pericardium
2. Descends through the diaphragm to the abdomen, connecting successively with the Upper, Middle, and Lower Jiao (San Jiao)
3. BRANCH: from inside the chest, emerges at the costal region 3 cun below the anterior axillary fold (PC1 Tianchi), ascends to the axilla
4. Runs down the medial aspect of the upper arm, BETWEEN the Lung channel (anterior) and Heart channel (posterior)
5. Crosses the cubital fossa (PC3 Quze), continues down the forearm between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis
6. Crosses the wrist (PC7 Daling), through the palm (PC8 Laogong), ending at the tip of the middle finger (PC9 Zhongchong)
7. BRANCH: arises from the palm at PC8 Laogong, runs along the ring finger to its tip, links with the SAN JIAO channel

PC -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Pericardium Meridian

SJ -- SAN JIAO / TRIPLE ENERGIZER

23 pts | Fire (Ministerial) | Yang | 9-11 PM | Hand -> Head

Category	Detail
Full name	San Jiao (Triple Energizer) Meridian of Hand-Shaoyang
Pertains / Connects	San Jiao (Triple Burner) / Pericardium
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL22 Sanjiaoshu / CV5 Shimen
Yuan-Source	SJ4 Yangchi
Luo-Connecting	SJ5 Waiguan
He-Sea	SJ10 Tianjing
Xi-Cleft	SJ7 Huizong
Confluent	SJ5 -- opens Yang Wei Mai (paired w/ GB41)
Command Point	none
Crossing Points	10+ -- shares crossing points with GB around head/ear/shoulder, plus GV14, SI12
First / Last Point	SJ1 Guanchong / SJ23 Sizhukong

FUNCTIONS

- No physical organ -- a "function organ" governing the Upper/Middle/Lower Jiao (fluid pathways and overall Qi transformation)
- SJ5 opens the Yang Wei Mai (paired with GB41) -- treats exterior wind-heat / alternating chills and fever
- Governs water passage/metabolism -- controls the movement of water through the three jiao
- Shares extensive crossing points with GB around the head, ear, and shoulder (both are Shaoyang channels)
- Active 9-11 PM -- the San Jiao "connects all organs" and is classically associated with rest during this window

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Ear disorders: tinnitus, deafness, ear pain/fullness (SJ reaches deep around the ear)
- Edema and water-metabolism disorders (SJ governs fluid pathways)
- Lateral head and temple pain, alongside GB
- Alternating chills and fever, exterior Wind-Heat presentations (via SJ5/Yang Wei Mai)
- Throat and eye-region disorders on the lateral face

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

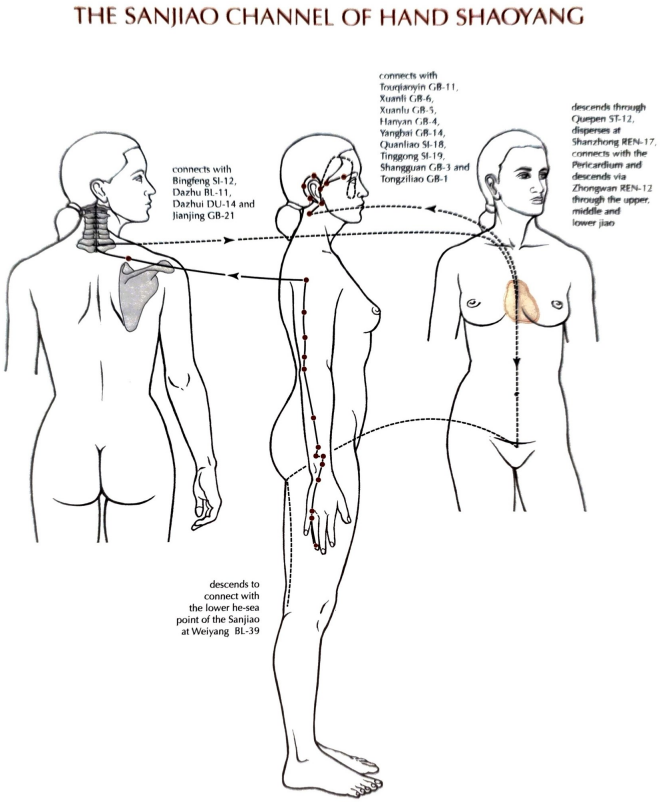
Point	Category	Clinical Use
SJ5	Luo-Connecting + Confluent	opens Yang Wei Mai (paired w/ GB41); exterior Wind-Heat, alternating chills/fever
SJ4	Yuan-Source	wrist disorders, general Qi regulation
SJ10	He-Sea	clears heat, ear disorders
SJ17	Crossing point (shared with GB)	deep ear point, facial paralysis, tinnitus
SJ23	Last point	lateral eyebrow -- headache, eye disorders

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- SJ has no corresponding physical organ in Western anatomy -- it's a classical "function" governing fluid pathways across all three jiao.
- SJ5 opening the Yang Wei Mai (paired with GB41 opening Dai Mai) is the Middle Circuit's confluent pairing -- contrast with PC6+SP4 from the other circuit.
- SJ and GB share extensive crossing points around the head/ear/shoulder because both are Shaoyang channels -- the "same-name channel" rule.
- Active 9-11 PM -- classic sleep-hygiene teaching point tied directly to this channel's clock position.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- San Jiao / Triple Energizer Meridian

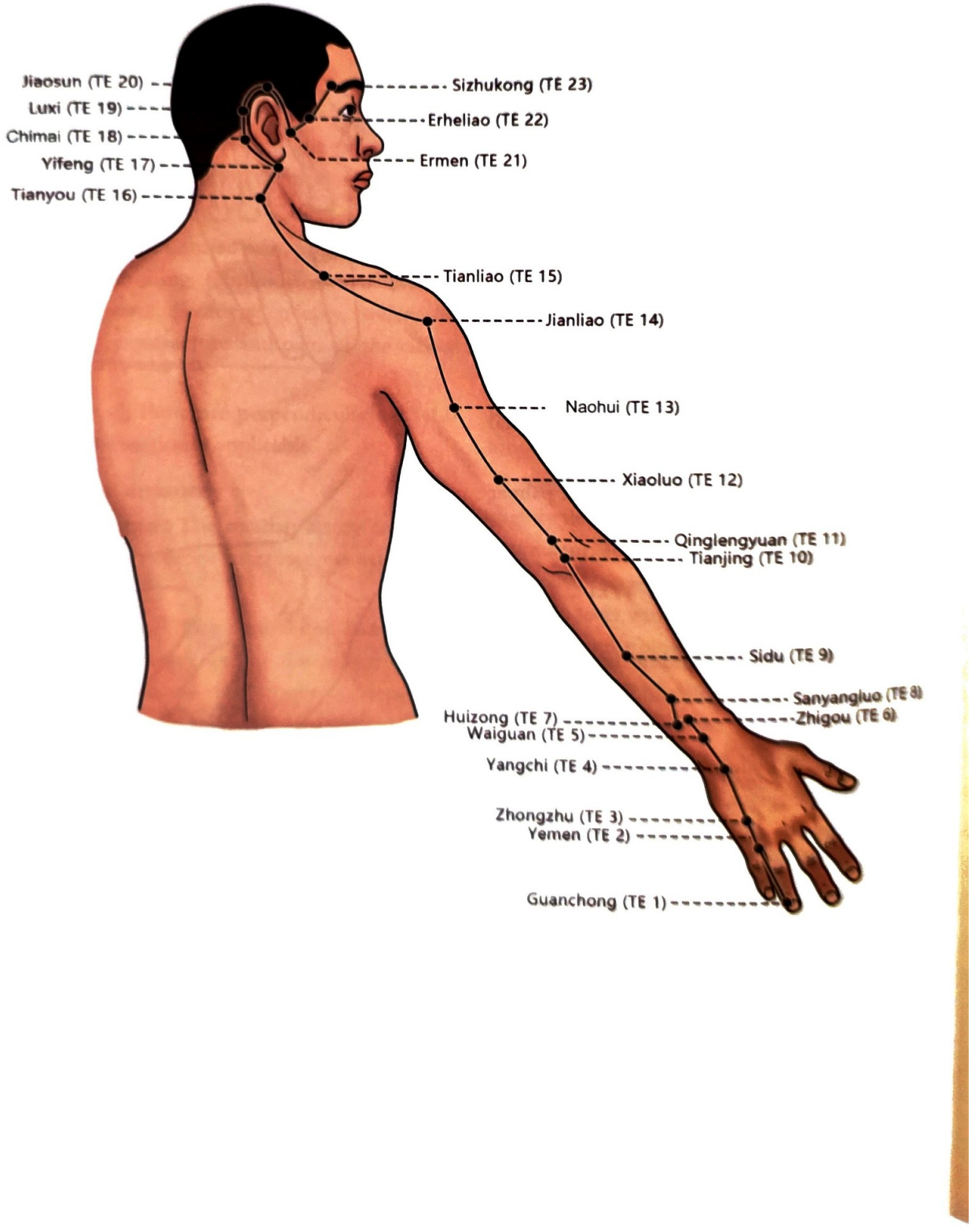
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Originates at the tip of the ring finger (SJ1 Guanchong)
2. Runs upward between the 4th and 5th metacarpal bones, along the dorsal wrist, to the lateral forearm between radius and ulna
3. Passes the olecranon, ascends the lateral upper arm, reaches the shoulder -- crosses BEHIND the Gallbladder channel there
4. Winds to the supraclavicular fossa, spreads in the chest to connect with the Pericardium
5. Descends through the diaphragm to the abdomen, enters its pertaining organ: Upper, Middle, and Lower Jiao
6. BRANCH: from the chest, ascends through the supraclavicular fossa, up the neck, along the posterior border of the ear, to the corner of the anterior hairline, then turns down to the cheek, terminates infraorbitally
7. BRANCH (auricular): arises retroauricularly, enters the ear, exits in front of the ear, crosses the cheek branch, reaches SJ23 Sizhukong, links with the GALLBLADDER channel at the outer canthus

SJ -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- San Jiao / Triple Energizer Meridian

GB -- GALLBLADDER

44 pts | Wood | Yang | 11 PM-1 AM | Head -> Foot

Category	Detail
Full name	Gallbladder Meridian of Foot-Shaoyang
Pertains / Connects	Gallbladder / Liver
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL19 Danshu / GB24 Riyue (own)
Yuan-Source	GB40 Qiuxu
Luo-Connecting	GB37 Guangming
He-Sea	GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews)
Xi-Cleft	GB36 Waiqiu
Confluent	GB41 Zulinqi -- opens Dai Mai (paired w/ SJ5)
Command Point	none
Crossing Points	12, across 6 meridians (SJ, LR, PC, SI, ST, GV) -- unique zig-zag "Z-shape" head course
First / Last Point	GB1 Tongziliao / GB44 Zuqiaoyin

FUNCTIONS

- 3rd largest channel (44 points) after BL (67) and ST (45)
- GB34 is the Hui-Meeting Point for sinews/tendons -- master point for tendon/ligament disorders
- Alternating fever/chills + bitter taste in the mouth = classic Shaoyang syndrome, specific to GB
- Unique zigzag ("Z-shape") course on the head -- an exam-testable visual signature unlike any other channel
- GB41 opens the Dai Mai (paired with SJ5) -- the only channel whose confluent point connects to an EV that encircles the waist

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Lateral headache, migraine, dizziness/vertigo (GB's zigzag head course)
- Tendon/sinew disorders, muscle cramping and spasm (GB34, Hui-Meeting of Sinews)
- Hypochondriac (rib-side) pain, alternating fever and chills, bitter taste in the mouth (Shaoyang syndrome)
- Lateral-body and hip pain along the long leg pathway
- Eye disorders (GB begins at the outer canthus)

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

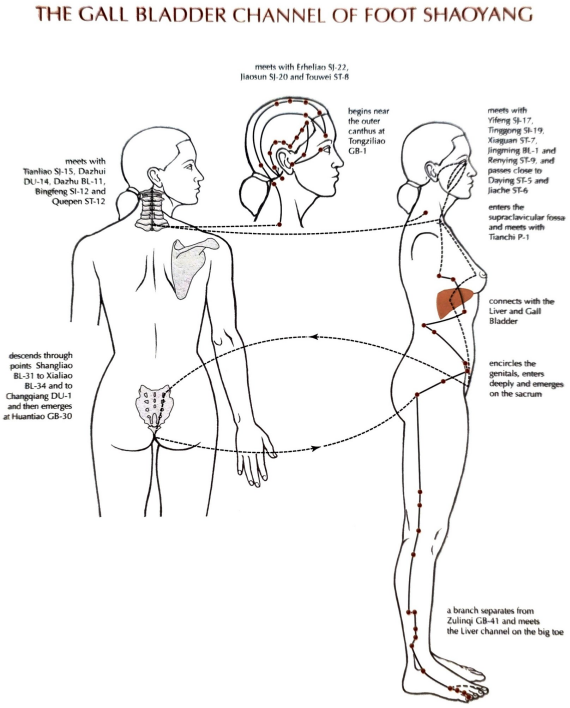
Point	Category	Clinical Use
GB34	He-Sea + Hui-Meeting (Sinews)	master point for tendon/ligament/muscle-spasm disorders
GB20	high clinical use (not a special point)	head/neck tension, headache -- one of the most-used GB points in clinic
GB41	Confluent (Dai Mai)	paired with SJ5; flank/waist and lateral-body disorders
GB24	Front-Mu (own)	hypochondriac pain, Liver-Gallbladder disharmony
GB21	high clinical use -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy	strong descending/labor-inducing action

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- GB has 12 crossing points across 6 meridians (SJ, LR, PC, SI, ST, GV) -- the full 2026-deck-confirmed list resolved an earlier discrepancy.
- GB34 + LR3 is a classic combination for tendon disorders with a Liver-Qi component (tight, spasming muscles).
- GB21 is FORBIDDEN in pregnancy -- a strong descending, labor-inducing action consistent with GB's overall "descending" channel character.
- GB's unique Z-shape head course is its own visual identifier -- no other channel zigzags this way.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Gallbladder Meridian

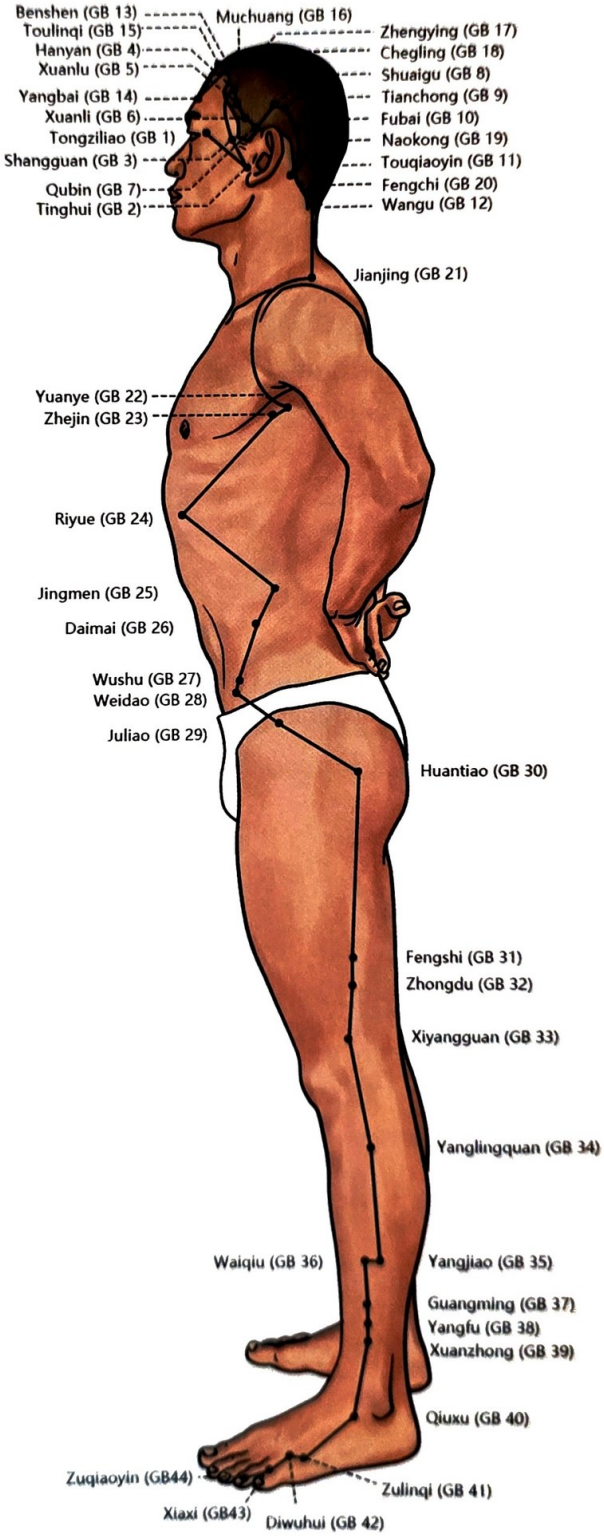
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Originates at the outer canthus (GB1 Tongziliao)
2. Ascends to the corner of the forehead (GB4 Hanyan), then curves down to the retroauricular region (GB20 Fengchi)
3. Runs along the side of the neck, in FRONT of San Jiao to the shoulder, then turns back and crosses BEHIND San Jiao, down to the supraclavicular fossa
4. BRANCH (head): from behind the ear, enters the ear, exits in front, to the posterior aspect of the outer canthus
5. BRANCH (canthus): from the outer canthus down to the ST5/6 region, meets San Jiao infraorbitally, descends to the neck, rejoins the main channel at the supraclavicular fossa
6. MAIN INTERNAL branch: from the supraclavicular fossa, descends through the diaphragm, connects with the Liver, enters its pertaining organ the Gallbladder; continues through the hypochondriac region, emerges at the inguinal region, circles the pubic hair margin, transverses to the hip (GB30 Huantiao)
7. STRAIGHT/EXTERNAL portion: from the supraclavicular fossa, descends in front of the axilla, along the lateral chest and free ends of the floating ribs (GB24-GB25), to the hip where it joins the internal branch (GB30)
8. Continues down the lateral thigh and knee, along the anterior fibula, to GB39 Xuanzhong, in front of the external malleolus, along the dorsum of the foot to the lateral tip of the 4th toe (GB44)
9. BRANCH: from the dorsum of the foot, to the great toe, links with the LIVER channel

GB -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Gallbladder Meridian

LR -- LIVER

14 pts | Wood | Yin | 1-3 AM | Foot -> Chest

Category	Detail
Full name	Liver Meridian of Foot-Jueyin
Pertains / Connects	Liver / Gallbladder
Back-Shu / Front-Mu	BL18 Ganshu / LR14 Qimen (own)
Yuan-Source	LR3 Taichong
Luo-Connecting	LR5 Ligou
He-Sea	LR8 Ququan
Xi-Cleft	LR6 Zhongdu
Confluent	none directly (LR13 is the SP Front-Mu; LR14 is LR's own Front-Mu)
Command Point	none
Crossing Points	6, shared with CV (2) and SP (1) around the genital/abdomen region
First / Last Point	LR1 Dadun / LR14 Qimen -- smallest Yin channel of the foot, crosses IN FRONT of SP at 8 cun above medial malleolus (the one exception)

FUNCTIONS

- Governs the smooth flow of Qi throughout the body -- Liver Qi stagnation is the most common TCM pattern taught from this channel
- Crosses IN FRONT of SP at 8 cun above the medial malleolus -- the single exception to the standard leg-Yin ordering rule
- Stores Blood; opens into the eyes (Liver Blood nourishes the eyes) -- explains why LR reaches the eye system and the vertex
- ONLY primary channel to reach the VERTEX (GV20) -- vertex headache points to Liver
- Completes the 12-channel Qi cycle by connecting back to LU internally -- "the total basic circulation of the 12 primary meridians"

CLINICAL INDICATIONS

- Vertex headache, dizziness, eye disorders (blurry vision, red/dry eyes) -- Liver Blood/Qi disorders
- Menstrual irregularity, genital/reproductive disorders (LR pathway reaches the genitals)
- Emotional disorders: irritability, depression, mood swings (Liver Qi stagnation)
- Hypochondriac/rib-side pain, distension
- Muscle cramping, tremor (Liver governs the sinews together with GB)

HIGHEST-YIELD POINTS

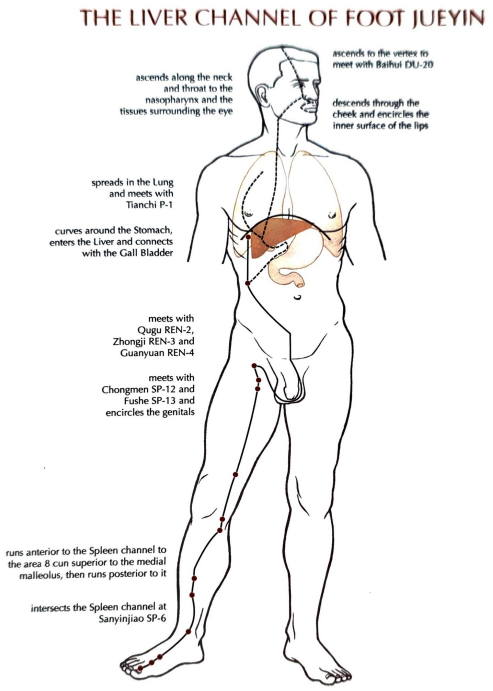
Point	Category	Clinical Use
LR3	Yuan-Source	the single most important point on LR -- smooths Liver Qi, used in "Four Gates" with LI4
LR13	Front-Mu of SPLEEN + Hui-Meeting of Zang	DOUBLE designation -- easy exam mix-up, sits on LR channel but serves SP
LR14	Front-Mu of LIVER (own)	Liver-Spleen disharmony, hypochondriac pain
LR8	He-Sea	nourishes Liver Blood/Yin, paired with KI10
LR1	Jing-Well	first point; uterine bleeding, emergency use

CLINICAL PEARLS & EXAM TRAPS

- LR3 + LI4 = the "Four Gates" (Si Guan) -- classic combination that smooths Qi and moves Blood broadly, used for pain of many origins.
- LR is the ONLY primary channel reaching the vertex (GV20) -- vertex headache is a Liver-pattern clinical cue.
- LR13 carries a DOUBLE special-point designation (Front-Mu of SP + Hui-Meeting of all Zang organs) -- easy to mix up on an exam with LR14 (LR's own Front-Mu).
- The 8-cun SP/LR crossover is the single exception to the standard leg-Yin ordering -- LR crosses in FRONT of SP at that point.

MOA -- INTERNAL PATHWAY (Deadman)

Organ-level course: chest/abdomen branches, internal connections



Source: A Manual of Acupuncture (Deadman, 3rd Ed.) -- Liver Meridian

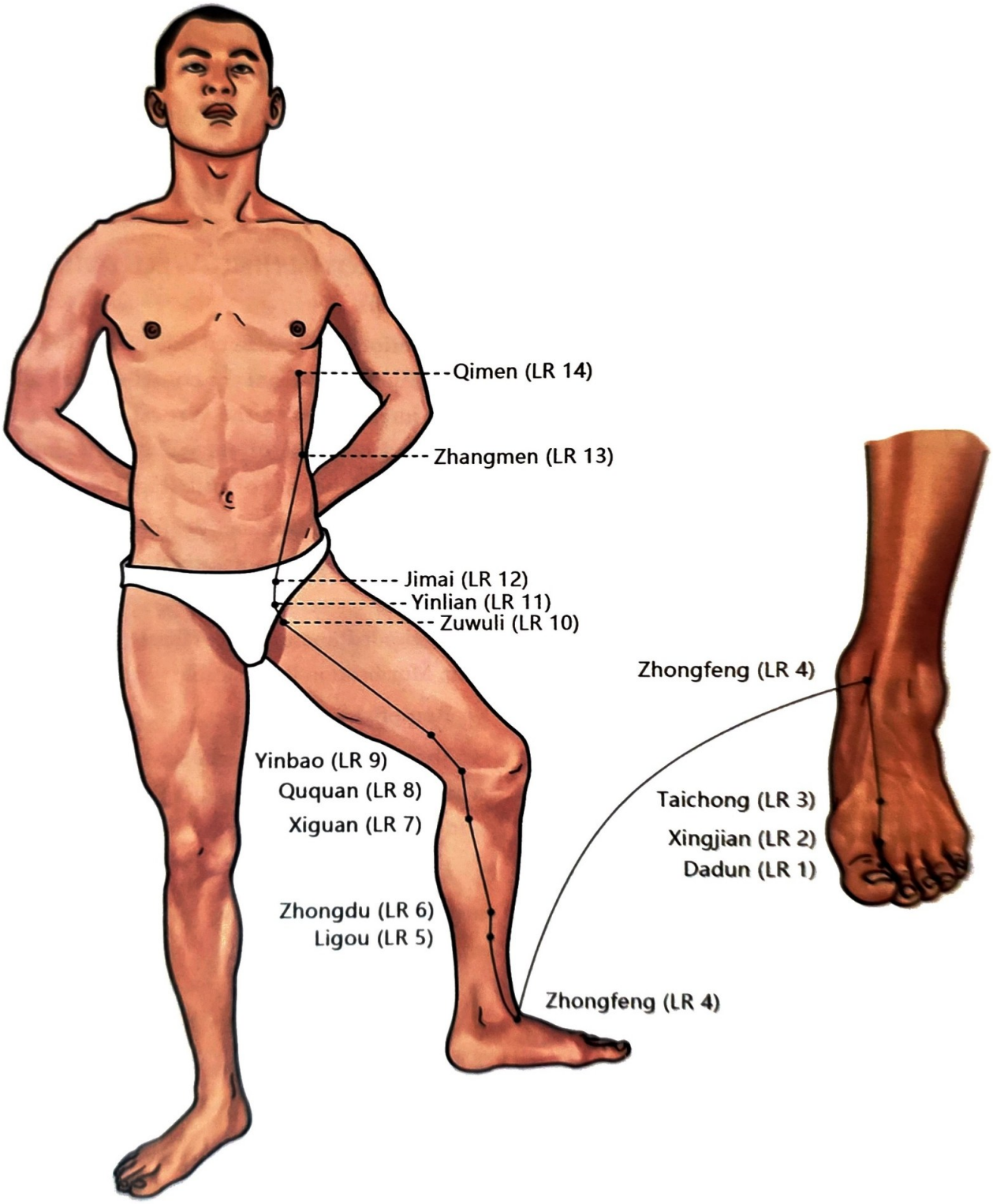
FULL PATHWAY COURSE -- INTERNAL + EXTERNAL

Step by step, in sequence

1. Begins at the lateral side of the great toe (LR1 Dadun), runs along the dorsum of the foot
2. At 8 cun above the medial malleolus, crosses IN FRONT of the Spleen channel (the exception to the usual anterior/middle/posterior leg-Yin order)
3. Ascends the medial knee and thigh to the pubic region, circles the genitals, enters the lower abdomen
4. Curves around the Stomach, enters the Liver (its pertaining organ), connects with the Gallbladder
5. Continues up through the diaphragm, spreads through the costal/hypochondriac region
6. Ascends along the posterior trachea/throat, connects with the eye system, EMERGES AT THE FOREHEAD, meets the Governing Vessel AT THE VERTEX (GV20 Baihui) -- unique among primary channels for reaching the vertex
7. BRANCH (cheek): from the eye system, descends to the cheek, circles the inner lips
8. BRANCH (internal): from the Liver, through the diaphragm, into the Lung, connects with the LUNG channel -- completes the 12-channel cycle back to LU

LR -- CAM EXTERNAL POINT MAP

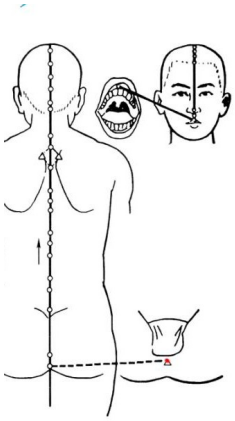
Every point, numbered and located on the body surface



Source: Chinese Acupuncture and Moxibustion (CAM, Cheng Xinnong, 4th Ed.) -- Liver Meridian

EIGHT EXTRAORDINARY VESSELS

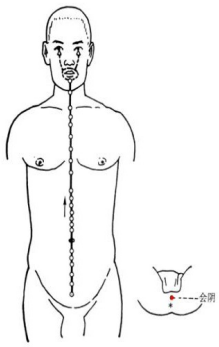
Week 7 -- confluent points started live in Week 9 review



GV -- Governor Vessel (Du Mai)

28 pts | Sea: Sea of the Yang Meridians | Confluent: SI3 Houxi (partner: BL62 Shenmai (Yang Qiao Mai)) | Course: Perineum -> posterior midline of spine -> nape -> vertex -> forehead -> nose -> upper gum | Function: Governs Qi of all Yang meridians; keeps body warm; spine/brain disorders

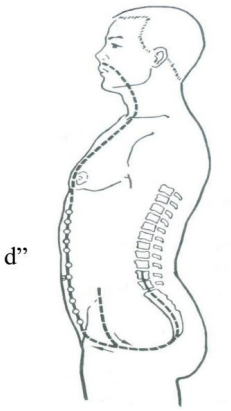
Indications: Stiff/rigid spine, opisthotonos, epilepsy-type disorders, febrile disease with coma, headache and heaviness at the vertex, low back pain along the spine. Classically described as the "Sea of Yang" -- a deficient GV shows as cold-natured, weak-yang presentations (frequent colds, cold low back/knees).



CV -- Conception Vessel (Ren Mai)

24 pts | Sea: Sea of the Yin Meridians | Confluent: LU7 Lieque (partner: KI6 Zhaohai (Yin Qiao Mai)) | Course: Perineum -> anterior midline of abdomen/chest -> throat -> chin | Function: Receives/bears Qi of all Yin meridians; reproduction, urogenital, CV4/CV12 major tonics

Indications: Menstrual irregularity, infertility, hernia, abdominal masses/lumps (classically "Seven Accumulations"), urogenital disorders, vaginal discharge. Classically the "Sea of Yin" -- pairs conceptually with GV as the two great midline vessels, front and back.

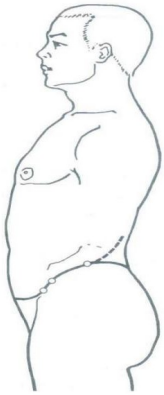


Chong -- Penetrating Vessel (Chong Mai)

no own points (except GV/CV) | Sea: Sea of the 12 Meridians / Sea of Blood | Confluent: SP4 Gongsun (partner: PC6 Neiguan (Yin Wei Mai)) | Course: Lower abdomen, runs parallel to Kidney meridian | Function: Sea of Blood; regulates menstruation and the 12 meridians/zang-fu Qi-Blood

Indications: Irregular menstruation, infertility, miscarriage, abdominal pain with a sensation of Qi rushing upward ("rebellious Qi" pattern), asthma-like breathlessness from Qi counterflow. Closely tied to the Kidney and to the Uterus (Bao Gong) in classical gynecology.

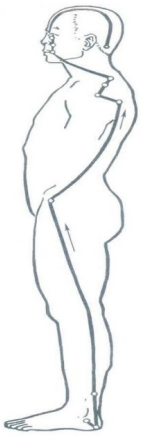
Dai -- Girdle/Belt Vessel (Dai Mai)



no own points (except GV/CV) | Sea: none (structurally unique) | Confluent: GB41 Zulinqi (partner: SJ5 Waiguan (Yang Wei Mai)) | Course: Encircles the waist like a belt | Function: Binds/controls all longitudinally-running meridians

Indications: Weakness/soreness of the low back and abdomen "as if sitting in water," excessive vaginal discharge (leukorrhea), abdominal distension/fullness, sensation of looseness or lack of support through the trunk. Classic teaching: Dai Mai "binds" the longitudinal vessels the way a belt gathers loose fabric.

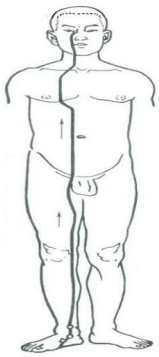
Yang Qiao -- Yang Heel Vessel (Yang Qiao Mai)



no own points (except GV/CV) | Sea: none | Confluent: BL62 Shenmai (partner: SI3 Houxi (Du Mai)) | Course: Lateral leg -> trunk -> meets Yin Qiao at inner canthus | Function: Governs wakefulness/activity; balances limb movement with Yin Qiao

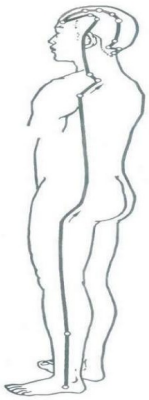
Indications: Insomnia (excess pattern -- can't fall asleep, Yang Qiao overactive), lower-limb spasm/rigidity on the lateral side, epilepsy with backward-arching convulsions, red and painful eyes. Paired functionally with Yin Qiao: the two together govern the opening/closing of the eyes and the sleep-wake cycle.

Yin Qiao -- Yin Heel Vessel (Yin Qiao Mai)



no own points (except GV/CV) | Sea: none | Confluent: KI6 Zhaohai (partner: LU7 Lieque (Ren Mai)) | Course: Medial leg -> trunk -> meets Yang Qiao at inner canthus | Function: Governs calm/rest, promotes sleep -- opposite of Yang Qiao

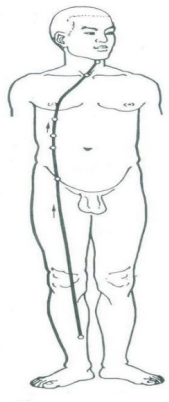
Indications: Somnolence/excess sleepiness (Yin Qiao overactive pattern), lower-limb spasm/rigidity on the medial side, throat obstruction sensation, epilepsy with forward-flexing convulsions. KI6 (its confluent point) is a first-line point for insomnia due to Yin deficiency with restlessness.



Yang Wei -- Yang Linking Vessel (Yang Wei Mai)

no own points (except GV/CV) | Sea: none | Confluent: SJ5 Waiguan (partner: GB41 Zulinqi (Dai Mai)) | Course: Lateral leg/trunk -> head | Function: Dominates exterior of the whole body

Indications: Alternating chills and fever (exterior Shaoyang-type presentation), lateral headache, exterior Wind-invasion symptoms that don't resolve normally. Classical teaching: when Yang Wei is diseased, the person cannot maintain the exterior -- hence the chills-and-fever pattern.



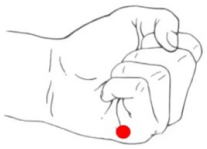
Yin Wei -- Yin Linking Vessel (Yin Wei Mai)

no own points (except GV/CV) | Sea: none | Confluent: PC6 Neiguan (partner: SP4 Gongsun (Chong Mai)) | Course: Medial leg/trunk -> chest | Function: Dominates interior of the whole body

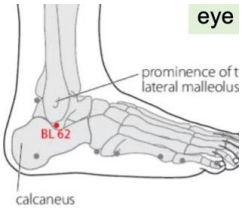
Indications: Heart pain / chest pain (cardiac-type), stomach pain, epigastric/abdominal pain -- interior-type pain patterns. Classical teaching: when Yin Wei is diseased, the person cannot maintain the interior -- hence pain in the chest and stomach. PC6 + SP4 is the most-used confluent pairing in clinic largely because of this vessel's action.

EIGHT CONFLUENT POINTS -- LOCATIONS

Connect the 8 EVs to the 12 regular meridians



Spine pain, fever

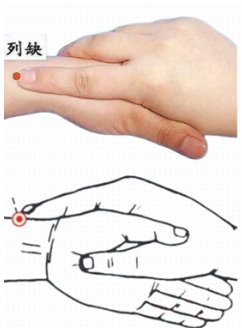


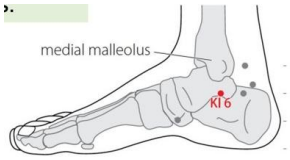
SI3 Houxi + BL62 Shenmai

Opens: Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

Use: posterior body, spine, neck, febrile disease

Classic combination for acute spinal rigidity and neck stiffness -- SI3 is also the Shu-Stream point of SI, giving it a dual mechanism for pain along the whole posterior line.



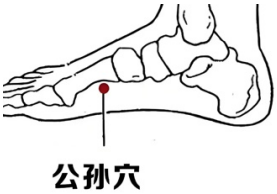


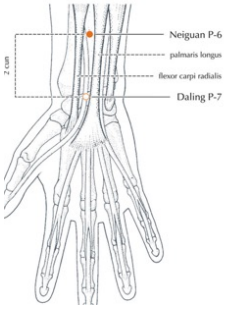
LU7 Lieque + KI6 Zhaohai

Opens: Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

Use: throat, chest, lung, insomnia

LU7 is also LU's Luo-Connecting point; KI6 is the vessel's own confluent gateway. Together they treat throat-chest disorders with an insomnia/restlessness component -- classic for Yin-deficiency insomnia.



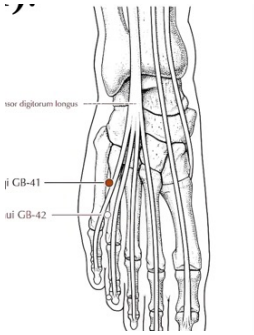


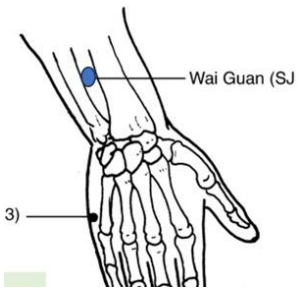
SP4 Gongsun + PC6 Neiguan

Opens: Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

Use: chest, heart, stomach -- MOST-used pairing in clinic

The single most clinically-used confluent pair. Both points are ALSO their own channel's Luo-Connecting point, so this combination doubles up on Luo + Confluent mechanisms simultaneously.





GB41 Zulinqi + SJ5 Waiguan

Opens: Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

Use: lateral body, hypochondriac pain, exterior disorders

Both are Shaoyang-channel points (same-name channel rule), reinforcing the lateral-body, alternating-fever-and-chills clinical picture shared by Dai Mai and Yang Wei Mai.

MERIDIANS VS. COLLATERALS -- THE CONCEPTUAL DIFFERENCE

Week 1 lecture deck

Meridians and Collaterals

	Meridians (Jingmai)	Collaterals (Luomai)
Meaning	Pathway	Network
Standing	Trunk	Branch
Distribution	Vertical line	Running amok
Depth	Deep	Shallow
Number	Few	Many
Function	**Leading** The pathways through which qi and blood circulate	**Supplement and Bond** The function of promoting qi and blood circulation

《灵枢》：“经脉为里，支而横者为络，络之别者为孙。”

Source: Dr. Zhang's Week 1 lecture deck

15 COLLATERALS -- LUO-CONNECTING POINTS

Week 8

Luo Point	Connection	Note
LU7 Lieque	LU -> LI	also opens Ren Mai (Week 7)
LI6 Pianli	LI -> LU	closest pairing around the wrist to LU7
ST40 Fenglong	ST -> SP	#1 phlegm point in TCM
SP4 Gongsun	SP -> ST	also opens Chong Mai
HT5 Tongli	HT -> SI	1 cun above wrist crease
SI7 Zhizheng	SI -> HT	5 cun above wrist
BL58 Feiyang	BL -> KI	7 cun above external malleolus
KI4 Dazhong	KI -> BL	posterior to internal malleolus
PC6 Neiguan	PC -> SJ	also opens Yin Wei Mai
SJ5 Waiguan	SJ -> PC	also opens Yang Wei Mai
GB37 Guangming	GB -> LR	5 cun above external malleolus
LR5 Ligou	LR -> GB	5 cun above internal malleolus
CV15 Jiuwei	Ren Mai collateral	spreads over the FRONT midline/abdomen
GV1 Changqiang	Du Mai collateral	spreads over the BACK midline
SP21 Dabao	Great (Major) Collateral of Spleen	covers the LATERAL chest -- why there are 15, not 12

Connecting (Luo) points of HAND meridians cluster around the WRIST. Connecting points of FOOT meridians cluster around the ANKLE/MALLEOLUS. CV/GV/SP-Great-Luo are the exceptions, covering front midline, back midline, and lateral chest respectively.

DIVERGENT / SINEW / CUTANEOUS -- LOW PRIORITY FOR THE FINAL

Dr. Zhang confirmed live in the Week 9 final-exam review that Divergent Channels and Collaterals detail is NOT covered in the review portion for the final. Muscle (Sinew) Regions and the 12 Cutaneous Regions were likewise absent from her review slides. Know the definitions below at a conceptual level only -- do not spend final-prep time memorizing individual divergent-channel pathways.

12 Divergent Channels

12 Divergent Channels branch from the 12 primary meridians and run DEEP into the body to strengthen the connection with the Zang-Fu organs (unlike the superficial Collaterals). Basic pattern: LI (⊔, 'separate/begin') -> travels through the trunk to the associated organ(s) -> emerges around the neck/face -> merges into its paired YANG meridian. All Yin divergent channels ultimately merge into a Yang meridian.

12 Sinew (Muscle) Regions

12 Muscle (Sinew) Regions follow the same surface course as their primary meridian but cover a WIDER band and connect specifically to muscles/tendons -- used clinically for motion dysfunction, muscle pain, and stiffness (e.g., gua sha, cupping, massage, motor-point needling).

12 Cutaneous Regions (-> 6 named)

12 Cutaneous Regions are the most superficial layer -- the skin-surface reflection of each meridian's range, first line of defense against external pathogenic invasion. Exception: cutaneous regions connect BOTH the hand and foot channels of the same Yin/Yang category together (e.g., Hand + Foot Taiyang are one cutaneous region) -- this is why there are only 6 named cutaneous regions, not 12 separate ones.

FIVE SHU POINTS -- MASTER TABLE (60 POINTS)

Week 9 -- all 12 meridians

A specific group of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, situated distal to the elbows/knees: Jing-Well ("where it emerges", tips of fingers/toes, first aid/resuscitation), Ying-Spring ("where it flows", before MCP/MTP, febrile disease), Shu-Stream ("where it pours", after MCP/MTP, heaviness & joint pain), Jing-River ("where it travels", forearm/lower leg, externally-contracted disease), He-Sea ("where it enters", near elbow/knee, disorders of the six Fu).

Split into two narrower tables (Jing-Well/Ying-Spring/Shu-Stream, then Jing-River/He-Sea) so neither requires horizontal scrolling on a phone or tablet.

Jing-Well -> Ying-Spring -> Shu-Stream

Meridian	Jing-Well	Ying-Spring	Shu-Stream
Lung (LU)	LU11 Shaoshang	LU10 Yuji	LU9 Taiyuan
Large Intestine (LI)	LI1 Shangyang	LI2 Erjian	LI3 Sanjian
Stomach (ST)	ST45 Lidui	ST44 Neiting	ST43 Xiangu
Spleen (SP)	SP1 Yinbai	SP2 Dadu	SP3 Taibai
Heart (HT)	HT9 Shaochong	HT8 Shaofu	HT7 Shenmen
Small Intestine (SI)	SI1 Shaoze	SI2 Qiangu	SI3 Houxi
Bladder (BL)	BL67 Zhiyin	BL66 Zutonggu	BL65 Shugu
Kidney (KI)	KI1 Yongquan	KI2 Rangu	KI3 Taixi
Pericardium (PC)	PC9 Zhongchong	PC8 Laogong	PC7 Daling
San Jiao (SJ)	SJ1 Guanchong	SJ2 Yemen	SJ3 Zhongzhu
Gallbladder (GB)	GB44 Zuqiaoyin	GB43 Xiaxi	GB41 Zulinqi
Liver (LR)	LR1 Dadun	LR2 Xingjian	LR3 Taichong

Jing-River -> He-Sea

Meridian	Jing-River	He-Sea
Lung (LU)	LU8 Jingqu	LU5 Chize
Large Intestine (LI)	LI5 Yangxi	LI11 Quchi
Stomach (ST)	ST41 Jiexi	ST36 Zusanli
Spleen (SP)	SP5 Shangqiu	SP9 Yinlingquan
Heart (HT)	HT4 Lingdao	HT3 Shaohai
Small Intestine (SI)	SI5 Yanggu	SI8 Xiaohai
Bladder (BL)	BL60 Kunlun	BL40 Weizhong
Kidney (KI)	KI7 Fuliu	KI10 Yingu
Pericardium (PC)	PC5 Jianshi	PC3 Quze
San Jiao (SJ)	SJ6 Zhigou	SJ10 Tianjing
Gallbladder (GB)	GB38 Yangfu	GB34 Yanglingquan
Liver (LR)	LR4 Zhongfeng	LR8 Ququan

Yin meridians have NO separate Yuan-Source point -- the Shu-Stream point IS the Yuan point (e.g. Taiyuan LU9 is both Shu-Stream and Yuan for Lung; Taixi KI3 for Kidney). Yang meridians have a 6th, separate Yuan-Source point beyond the 5 Shu points (e.g. Chongyang ST42, Hegu LI4).

EXAM TRAPS -- CONSOLIDATED FROM EVERY WEEK

Read this page last, right before the final

Naming convention	3 parts only: Hand/Foot + Yin/Yang + Zang/Fu (e.g. "Hand Taiyin Lung"). Element (Metal, Earth...) is a SEPARATE Five-Phase classification, not part of the formal channel name.
Point-count doesn't track Yin/Yang	LI (20) > LU (11); SI (19) > HT (9) -- the Yang/Fu partner almost always has more points than its Yin/Zang pair, even though it's the "lesser" organ in Zang-Fu theory.
ST begins at LI20, not ST1	ST1 (Chengqi) is only the first NUMBERED point on the channel -- the true pathway origin is LI20 Yingxiang on the face, a crossing point of the LI channel.
UPPER vs LOWER teeth/gums	UPPER teeth/gums = ST channel. LOWER teeth/gums = LI channel. A classic Dr. Zhang exam distinction.
ST25 vs CV12 Front-Mu	ST25 (Tianshu) = Front-Mu of LARGE INTESTINE. CV12 (Zhongwan) = Front-Mu of STOMACH. These sit on completely different channels.
Only ST passes through the nipple	ST17 Ruzhong = center of nipple -- landmark ONLY, never needled.
SP is the ONLY channel on the LOWER surface of the tongue	KI reaches the ROOT of the tongue; SP spreads over its lower surface -- do not conflate the two tongue relationships.
SP's 8-cun crossover	The ONLY distribution exception among all 12 meridians: below 8 cun above the medial malleolus, SP runs POSTERIOR to LR; above 8 cun, SP moves ANTERIOR (crosses in front of LR).
Forbidden-in-pregnancy points	LI4 Hegu, SP6 Sanyinjiao, BL60 Kunlun (promotes labor), BL67 Zhiyin (malposition correction via MOXA only, needle contraindicated).
Circuit hand-offs (Outer)	LU->LI at LI1 (fingers). LI->ST at LI20 (face). ST->SP at SP1/ST42 (toe). SP->HT internally (chest) -- opens the Inner/Posterior Circuit.
BL does NOT connect to Lung	BL's only internal connection is Kidney. Do not confuse with the Metal pathway.
BL's two back lines run simultaneously	NOT a sequential up-down loop -- Dr. Zhang confirmed directly in Q&A: both the 1.5-cun and 3-cun parallel lines run "at the same time."
BL7 vs GV20	BL7 Tongtian is NOT the vertex-joining point -- that is GV20 Baihui, which BL merely joins at the vertex.
Heel pain -> think Kidney first	Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical teaching point -- the KI pathway curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel.
KI3 vs KI7	KI3 Taixi = Shu-Stream AND Yuan-Source (dual role), in the malleolus/Achilles depression. KI7 Fuliu = Jing-River only, 2 cun proximal, anterior to the Achilles tendon.

PC and HT are the ONLY 2 primary channels with zero crossing points.	An easy paired exam trap.
Confluent point pairings never mix elements	SI3+BL62 (both Yang, posterior); LU7+KI6 (mixed but classic Yin pairing); SP4+PC6 (both Yin, most clinically used); GB41+SJ5 (both Yang, lateral body).
Yuan-Source rule by polarity	On YIN channels, Yuan-Source = the Shu-Stream point (same point, dual role). On YANG channels, Yuan-Source is a separate 6th point beyond the 5 Shu points.
ST36 is He-Sea + Command Abdomen, NOT Yuan-Source.	ST's actual Yuan-Source is ST42 Chongyang -- don't let ST36's fame as "#1 tonic point" cause you to misassign it.
GB crossing points: 12 across 6 meridians	SJ, LR, PC, SI, ST, GV -- includes Yifeng SJ17, Jiaosun SJ20, Erheliao SJ22, Dadun LR1, Zhangmen LR13, Tianchi PC1, Bingfeng SI12, Tianrong SI17, Tinggong SI19, Xiaguan ST7, Touwei ST8, Dazhui GV14.
Extraordinary Vessels have NO pertaining/connecting organs.	Unlike the 12 primary meridians, the 8 EVs run superficially and do not pertain to or connect with internal Zang-Fu organs directly.
Yang Qiao / Yin Qiao "start" at their confluent points.	BL62 (Yang Qiao) and KI6 (Yin Qiao) -- Dr. Zhang repeated this exact fact live in the Week 9 review as a quiz-recycled item.

COURSE MAP -- WEEKS 1-10

Syllabus reference

Week	Topic	Notes
Week 1	Channel Theory & Nomenclature	Foundational rules, 12 meridians overview, 3 circuits, clock
Week 2	LU / LI	Metal, Outer Circuit begins, Quiz 1-2 material
Week 3	ST / SP	Earth, Outer Circuit completes, ST=11 crossing points (mostly face/head)
Week 4	HT / SI	Fire, Inner/Posterior Circuit begins
Week 5	BL / KI	Water, Inner/Posterior Circuit completes -- largest (BL=67) + Water pair
Week 6	PC / SJ / GB / LR	Ministerial Fire + Wood, Middle Circuit complete
Week 7	Eight Extraordinary Vessels	GV, CV, Chong, Dai, Yang/Yin Qiao, Yang/Yin Wei; 8 Confluent Points
Week 8	Collaterals, Divergent Channels, Sinew Channels	15 Luo points, divergent theory, muscle regions
Week 9	Cutaneous Regions + Five Shu + Final Review	12 cutaneous regions, 60-point Five Shu master table, live Final Exam Review, clinical evidence (not exam material)
Week 10	COMPREHENSIVE FINAL EXAM	30 questions, cumulative, reuses quiz material